

Lesson 01

INTRODUCTION

Today we have loads of research evidence available that explains both masculinity, or male roles, and femininity, or female roles.

There are two Divisions of APA that directly deal with these issues:

Division 35: Society for the Psychology of Women, established 1973.

Division 51: Society for the Psychological Study of Men and Masculinity, established 1995.

Gender:

The perception of being a male or a female.

“Gender” versus “Sex”:

Gender refers to the psychological aspect whereas sex refers to the physiological or physical aspect of the same phenomenon.

“Gender” refers to culturally constructed categorization of “maleness” and “femaleness” or masculinity and femininity.

Biologically based distinctions between males and females are referred to as “Sex” of the person.

Who makes us behave as males or females?

Human-beings are born as male or female babies, BUT they become masculine or feminine as a result of child rearing practices and socio-cultural variables.

Gender roles:

Expectations of appropriate behavior for males and females set by a society.

Gender role expectations are very similar across societies.

Gender differences:

Actual differences between males and females in terms of average capacity, ability, or typical behavior.

Gender stereotypes:

“Widely held beliefs about females’ and male’s abilities, personality traits, and social behavior”

(Weiten, 2001).

Feminist Movement

Christine de Pizan:

- Generally considered the first feminist writer.
- 1785: The first scientific Society for Women established in Middle berg, Dutch, and Republic.
- 1791: “Declaration of the Rights of Women and the Female Citizen”.
- The “Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen” (1789) was paraphrased.
- It was the French revolution’s central document.
- 1792: Mary Wollstonecraft: “A Vindication of the Rights of Woman”.

The modern feminist movement emerged from the west.

A member of men as well as women contributed to the cause of improving women’s status in the society, in the political, economic, and social spheres.

All societies were patriarchal, male dominated, where women were generally oppressed and home bound.

Women were denied the right to franchise, to go for education, and profession. Woman was treated as a second rate citizen with limited or no ability, little or lower grade intelligence and non-trustable skill.

- 19th century Reform Movement was a landmark in the history of women liberation.

- 1848: New York: The first Women's Rights Convention

- J.S. Mill wrote "**The Subjection of Women**" in the mid-1800s. He was influenced by his wife Harriet

- Taylor.

Emmeline Pankhurst formed WSPU/Women's Social & Political Union..

- In the East Qasim Amin an Egyptian jurist is known as the Father of Egyptian feminist movement.

- In 1899 he wrote "Women's Liberation" and proved to be a very influential writer (Tahrir ul Mar'a).

WAVES OF THE FEMINIST MOVEMENT

First wave feminists

The early feminists, who initiated the movement.

Second wave feminists

By this time, women in most countries had been granted the right to franchise and to contest election for public office. These feminists were active after 1960. They were working for equality, both economic and social. They fought for the right to contraception, birth control and sexual liberation. Sexual liberation became a much debated issue and was criticized by many feminists.

Third wave feminists

Third wave movement emerged in the 1990's. The earlier feminists failed to see and deal with variations within women. Third wave feminists try to see how different groups of women may be having different needs, and circumstances, and requiring different solutions. Womanism, Queer theory, and Post Modern Feminism are a part of this wave.

Lesson 02

Feminist Movement

A movement or way of thinking that proposes, advocates, supports, and struggles for social equality of the two sexes. The difference between men and women should be looked into from a “gender” perspective rather than a “sexist” perspective. The difference between the sexes is ascribed or inherent but the gender abilities are attained. Society is the seed bed of our gender roles, gender Identity, and gender stratification.

Feminist movement had its roots in struggle for enlightenment, women’s rights, and legal and political rights.

The feminists demands :

- a) The significance of change in mindset of people or in society
- b) All human traits are found in all humans
- c) Equal rights and elimination of gender stratification.
- d) Curbing and bringing to an end all forms of violence against women.
- e) Promoting sexual independence.

Forms or Varieties of Feminism

1. Liberal Feminism : (1960s- 1970s)

Liberal feminism had roots in classic liberal thought; women should have the same rights as men.

2. Radical Feminism:

- Cultural notion of gender needs to be eliminated.
- Men are the oppressors and women oppressed.
- Racial or social class oppression follows the same model.

3. Socialist Feminism:

Rather than seeking liberation at individual level, men and women should be together in this pursuit.

4. Cultural Feminism:

- Social change is a must.
- Societies need to accept and appreciate traditionally feminine values.
- Woman suffrage movement & its ultimate success brought about major changes in terms of women’s status as well as their self- perceptions and vision.

The First World War was also a turning point. Many women who never worked outside home started working. But the end of war meant joblessness for many women. In piece time, the jobs were to be left for the soldiers returning home. Still many women carried on with nursing, farming, blue collared jobs & other traditional occupations. At the same time during the world war many women entered occupations that used to be restricted to men alone e.g. mechanical work. In many communist & socialist countries women were bought at equivalence with men in many regards.

Feminist movement saw tough times & discouragement in countries like Germany or Italy, in the early 20th country.

Women’s Movement in the Sub-continent:

- Began in the 1920s
- AIWC: Established in 1927: All India Women’s Conference was the flag bearer

- The initial agenda was females' education
- The fullest developmental of an individual's latent capacities along with the ideals of motherhood was emphasized. (motherhood education)
- Later on social transformation was also included in their agenda.
- Later on common curricula for all

WOMEN'S SUFFRAGE (VOTE RIGHT)

It was a reform movement for attaining the goal of suffrage to women .The movement had political and social aims to achieve.

- **Suffragists:** supporters and leaders of the suffrage movement. Any person, male or female, who supported suffrage for women.
- **Suffragettes:** Female supporters of the movement.

Initially equal (equal importance of both votes) rather than universal suffrage (everyone has right to vote is of equal importance) was the demand.

- **Equal suffrage:** Supporting the cause of abolishing the tradition and practice of graded votes.
- **Universal suffrage:** Right to vote without any discrimination. In many countries and parts of world, women's suffrage was granted much before universal suffrage; so women in these parts of the world had the right to vote before the men and women of some other races in various parts of the world.

History of Women Suffrage

Women got the suffrage right at different times in different parts of the world.

- 1776: New Jersey: first women suffrage & people were called, people, not men.
 - It was rescinded in 1807.
 - 1838: The Pitcairn Islands: Women were allowed suffrage. In South Australia, restricted women's suffrage was allowed.
 - 1871: The Paris Commune allowed the right that was later cancelled.
 - 1944: President de Gaulle reinstated the right.
 - 1893: New Zealand
 - 1894: South Australia
 - 1906: Finland: Women got universal and equal suffrage, and allowed to be candidates in election. Finland was the first European country to do so.
 - 1907: Finland: The world's first female Member of Parliament. Finland had 19 women members of parliament after the election.
 - 1913: Norway & Denmark: women got the right to vote.
 - 1917: Soviet Union and Canada
 - 1918: All German and Polish women and British women above 30 years of age got the right.
 - 1920: American states.
 - 1928: All British women were granted suffrage
 - 1926: the year of women suffrage in Turkey.
 - 1984: Liechtenstein: In central Europe, one of the smallest independent states in the world was one of the last places to allow equal suffrage to women.
- Today few countries exist where women do not have the right to franchise.
- In Bhutan, one vote one property is the rule, which makes women suffrage difficult.

Lesson 03

Historical Background

Two main viewpoints exist in psychology regarding gender differences:

1. Gender variation is biological and evolution-based in nature.....hence fixed and un alterable.
Biological differences are there.
2. It is the society that shapes and nurtures gender roles. The biological approach has roots in evolutionary psychology and has an essentialist nature.
3. The biosocial approach has a broader perspective and benefits from knowledge and research in Sociology, Anthropology, Ethnology, and off course Biology.

The main issues are tackled in these theories:

Who made us what we are? Were we born like that or are we a product of the environment and the society that we exist in?

Nature versus Nurture?

There is no denying the fact that men and women are biologically different, but are the roles adopted by us also predetermined? Or, is it that we are made to learn roles that suit our biological make-up?

We know that men are higher in physical strength and women in endurance and that may explain many of the roles that we play in life.

Minimalist and Maximalist views in Psychology:

Epstein, 1988 describes the two opposing viewpoints as **minimalist** and **maximalist**.

Maximalists believe in huge, fundamental, differences between men and women. A number of

Minimalists belong to the essentialist perspective.

Minimalist believes and proposes that there are few fundamental, deep, differences.

Earlier Schools of Thought in Psychology and Gender Differences:

Structuralism:

Structuralists were primarily interested in the structure of human mind. Adult mental processes were studied by using introspection. Structuralist's interest was in the investigation of "**generalized adult mind**" (Shields, 1975). They were not concerned with the effect of individual differences, including difference between men and women. Ignoring individual differences did not mean that structuralists treated men and women equally. The student subjects in structuralist experiments were males. The "**generalized adult mind**" therefore was a "**male mind**". In the U.S, women were expressly prohibited from one of the early groups of experimental psychologists (Schultz & Schultz, 2004).

Functionalism

Psychology and the psychologists took a more pragmatic and practical turn in the U.S. Functionalism focused upon the functions of the mind rather than the structure of mind. Functionalist researches included a wider variety of subjects including women, children, and animals. The structuralisms had excluded groups like children, animals, the feeble-minded and even women.

Impact of Studies on Intelligence and Adaptability:

Individuality and flexibility were two major areas of functionalist interest. As a consequence they researched into intelligence test development and study of individual differences. Individual differences in mental ability, and personality traits, including sex differences were being compared now.

The Darwinian influence impacted the functionalists as well. One of the popular areas of study was the biologically determined differences which included biological basis of sex differences.

That was perhaps the formal beginning of the empirical investigation of sex differences, although mostly quite biased. The findings usually tended to support the conventional male-female roles prevailing at that time. The impact of social influence in terms of sex differences was generally either ignored, not touched upon, or not considered worth investigation.

Some of the typical findings of such studies:

- Women were less intelligent than men.
- As compared to men women benefited less from education.
- Women, as compared to men, had a strong maternal instinct.
- Women were unlikely to produce examples of success or eminence
- The findings primarily suggested that females were intellectually deficient.

The functionalists were interested in “Nature” rather than “nurture”. Study of sex roles and cultural concepts of “masculine” and “feminine” did not interest them. The gender-biased views or findings of the functionalists faced strong criticism.

Female psychologists like Helen Thompson Woolley and Letta Stetter Hollingworth criticized, argued and took a stand against the functionalist view of women.

Woolley in the early 1900s raised the point that the sex-difference research reflected the researchers’ personal bias, sentiment, and prejudice.

Hollingworth believed that women’s potential can never be demonstrated unless they were given an opportunity to choose the life they would like, whether career or maternity, or both.

Behaviorism

This approach brought forth a new perspective. Behaviorism emerged almost as a reaction to the prevailing introspective, inner experience, approach. The subject matter of psychology for them was observable behavior alone, rather than inner experience or instinct.

The behaviorists emphasized “nurture”. Although their main emphasis was different from the functionalists, their approach towards sex differences was not much different. Their primary interest was in learning and memory. Sex differences and sex roles along with other social factors were ignored.

These early psychologists created “womanless” psychology. Their research negatively affected the attention required by the sex/gender difference issue in two ways:

Their research did not include women as participants, or when both men and women were participants, gender related variables were not examined.

Psychoanalytic Psychology

Psychoanalytic Psychology, founded by Sigmund Freud, has been the most influential yet most criticized approach in psychology. **Psychoanalytic psychology was the first to talk about sex differences, personality differences between men and women.** Freud’s theory gave an understanding of the conceptualization of sex and gender.

Freudian theory of personality:

Freud talked about the developmental stages of personality in terms of **“Psycho-sexual Development”**.

Personality is guided and run by basic energy; instincts are the source of energy. The most significant factor in personality formation is a child’s perception of anatomical difference between boys and girls.

The child’s perception of bodily differences between males and females leads to a realization of what they do not have. The resultant feeling and attitude leads to a crucial conflict i.e., an attraction towards the opposite-sex parent, and hostility towards the same-sex parent develops. The child ultimately reaches a resolution of this conflict in the form of identification with the same-sex parent. The case of a male child is graver in nature. He undergoes a deeper conflict and trauma in personality development.

The resolution comes in terms of complete identification with the father.

From this, Freud drew the hypothesis for which he may still be criticized: As compared to women, men typically form a stronger conscience and a sense of social values.

This issue was hotly contested and Freud criticized for what this thinking implied.

Those who believed in this theory interpreted it to imply that women were inferior to men.

Women were jealous of men’s achievements, were less ethical, more self-disapproving, and more concerned with their appearance.

Acceptance of a feminine role meant adopting low ranking opportunities and an inferior status. If any woman could not settle with this situation, she was considered to be a case requiring psychotherapy, since she was not accepting a role expected of her. This thinking not only hurt women but also touched men who thought otherwise. They felt that Freud was proposing and strengthening the idea of female subservience and a male dominated society.

Freudian theory gained unmatched popularity all over the world especially in the West. This had implications in terms of influence on popular thinking.

For the development of masculinity, the psychoanalytic theory had very stringent and inflexible standards:

The male child whose masculinity develops in a normal fashion undergoes very severe anxiety and conflict in early childhood

The child develops hatred for the father, fears him, and undergoes trauma. Then he realizes that instead of breaking from father he should identify with him, become like him, break from mother, and experience the advantages of manhood. Now, can all boys completely break away from mothers and fully identify with the father?

What about sons attached to mothers? Or fatherless sons?

The boys who could not break fully from mother, and did not completely identify with father, lack a normally developed masculinity and have feminine characteristics in their personality.

Psychoanalytic Feminism:

Psychoanalytic feminism Roots in the work of Freud. Gender is not a biologically determined phenomenon.

Psychosexual development leads to the gender role that we adopt and play.

Childhood experiences are responsible for making the male believe that he is masculine and making a female believe that she is feminine. These experiences lead to gender inequality. This is a result of a male dominated society.

Highlighted by Buzybee

Lesson 04

GENDER- RELATED RESEARCH

Research focusing upon:

a) The socio-psychological, economic, biological, and cultural-societal impact of gender stratification and gender roles.

b) It also explores the various aspects of gender relations and gender differences.

Gender research covers all sorts of issues pertaining to gender, especially the social and psychological life of women.

Feminist Research:

Research exploring the social, psychological, economic, biological, and cultural-societal aspects of women's life.

- The focus of research is the status and condition of women in the society.

- The basic premise of gender research is the idea that women generally experience reduction.

The objective of feminist research is to identify female's problems so that resolutions can be found.

- The ultimate goal is the improvement in the condition and status of women in the society.

Threats to Gender-related Research:

Margrit Eichler (1988) identified threats to sound research pertaining to gender:

- a) Androcentricity
- b) Over generalizing
- c) Gender blindness
- d) Double standards
- e) Interference

a) Andocentricity:

Most gender research, especially the initial one, had been andocentric i.e., looking at issues from the male perspective. For example: for many years the researchers studying occupations concentrated upon men's formal work and ignored female's domestic work and childcare.

The other extreme may be gynocentricity (female centered) i.e., evaluating things from women's point of view alone.

b) Overgeneralizing:

- In this type of bias the researchers take data from one segment of the population i.e., men, and generalize it to the rest of the population, including women.
- By doing so they are trying to support conclusions about both sexes.
- In some cases it may be the right and the only feasible approach. But in many cases it becomes a source of bias.
- Psychologists and sociologists, in many studies in the past, studied only male samples but generalized the findings to all mankind.
- They have been claiming that their findings and conclusions stood true about "humanity" rather than just men alone.
- Similarly, at times researchers study certain phenomenon in just female subjects and then later on apply the conclusions to men as well, whereas the phenomenon was more relevant to women but not to men.

- For example a study of “mothering” practices may not represent a true picture of “parenting” practices, but the researcher will have a tendency to quote the findings to be true about all parents.
- Overgeneralizing may also become a problem when findings about samples of all white, educated, and middle class females in a western society are applied to women from all over the world, belonging to different cultural backgrounds.

c) Gender Blindness:

Many researchers fail to see that gender differences exist in almost all spheres of life. For example many studies on the life of elderly people tended to ignore the fact that most elderly women live without husbands, whereas most elderly men live with wives.

d) Double Standards:

Researchers’ personal attitudes, thinking, and prejudices lead to double standards. When they talk about a couple, in terms of a man and women, they tend to assume that the man is the head of the family, runs it, and the woman does only support work in the household.

e) Interference:

At times the subject’s perception of the sex of the researcher interferes with the accurate fact finding process.

Maureen Giovannini (1992) experienced this phenomenon while studying a small community in Sicily. The very fact that she was a single woman caused problems for her in having private conversations with men, besides the fact that she was denied access to many places.

Gender research uses the scientific methodology:

Psychology is a science because it uses the scientific approach and methodology.

Scientific methodology:

The procedure for data collection employs a systematic, pre defined, series of steps for attaining optima efficiency, accuracy, and objectivity in investigating the problem of interest

Steps in Scientific Method

1. Identifying a research
2. Review of related research
3. Formulation of a hypothesis
4. Designing & Conducting research methodology
5. Analysis of data
6. Drawing conclusion

Conclusions back to identifying research

Identifying a Research Problem in Gender Research

- Personal interest& observation
- Popular issues
- Newly emerging needs/ new projects
- Events demand for research
- Review of Related Literature

Feminist/ Gender Research Methods

- Quantitative methods
- Qualitative methods

Quantitative methods

- Descriptive methods
- Experimental methods
- Ex Post Facto Studies

Descriptive Research Methods available to psychologists:

- Observation
- Correlational Research
- Surveys
- Unobtrusive Methods
- Case Studies
- Focus groups, Meta-analysis

Descriptive Research Methods Commonly Used

- Surveys
- Correlational studies
- Observation
- Content Analysis

Qualitative Research Methods

- Case studies
- Ethnography
- Focus Groups
- Interviews

Qualitative Research Methods

1. SURVEYS:

- Surveys are the best approach when quick information is required from a large number of people in limited time e.g., survey of how female students choose their future career path.
- In surveys the participants are presented with a series of questions or statements to which they have to respond.
- Surveys are most appropriate when the goal of the study is to find out about opinions, attitudes, prejudices, preferences, values, lifestyles etc.
- Surveys, at times, are the only resort for the researcher, especially when the phenomenon under study cannot be observed directly, either due to ethical constraints or because of procedural problems.

Data/ Information Sources in Surveys

- Questionnaires: given in person, mailed, or e- mailed.
- Interviews; face-to-face, personal, electronic, or Telephonic
- Newspaper or magazine surveys

Essentials for surveys:

- Trained, skillful, experienced interviewers.
- Careful and appropriate wording.

Limitations of surveys:

- In-depth study is not possible.
- Surveys ask questions rather than making direct measurement.
- Instead of direct observation we depend upon self-reports.
- Self-reports rely upon the respondents' memory.

Co relational Research:

Used for identifying predictive **relationships among naturally** occurring variables

Sources of Data in Correlational Research

Psychological tests: I.Q, personality, aptitude etc.

Questionnaires: in person, mailed, e-mailed.

Interviews: personal, telephonic.

Official Record: statistics, archival data.

Correlation:

- Basically a statistical concept.
- We can say a correlation exists between two variables when two different measures of the same individuals, objects, or events vary together e.g. relationship between aggressiveness score and stressful life events in recent past, or age and the number miles a person can walk.
- **Pearson Product Moment Correlation Coefficient (r)** is the most commonly used procedure.
- It yields a value ranging between +1.00 and -1.00, showing the magnitude as well as the direction of the relationship.

Nature of Correlation

- **Positive Correlation**
- **Negative Correlation**
- **Zero Correlation**

Remember! Correlation is not “causation” !!!

3. Observation:

- Systematic observation is one of the popular research methods employed method by anthropologists, sociologists, and ethnologists.
- The procedure involves observation, study, and careful recording of the phenomenon of interest.
- The recorded observations are analyzed later on.
- The analysis yields conclusions.

Types of Observation:

- Observation **without intervention**
- Observation **with intervention**

Observation **without intervention** refers to naturalistic observation

Observation **with intervention** includes: Participant observation, structured observation, and field experiments.

Lesson 05

RESEARCH METHODS FOR GENDER ISSUES

Content Analysis:

Content analysis is one of the most commonly used methods for assessing the impact of electronic media, literature, art, textbooks, and oral discussions. Content analysis is done keeping specific goals, objectives, themes, and constructs in mind.

It is a part of archival research. Concept is an approach for systematically categorizing and **analyzing the content of the behavior or its related aspects or variables being studied.** The analysis may cover contents of live human behavior, books, journals, magazines, poetry, drama, movies, folktales, TV programs, school textbooks and curricula, advertisements etc.

The Procedure of Content Analysis:

The content of the behavior or its related aspects/variables being **studied is systematically categorized** with reference to some theory. **The analyst scans contents of live human behavior, books, journals, magazines, poetry, drama, movies, folk tales, TV programs, school curricula, advertisements etc.** according to the categories under consideration. Once objective identification of specific characteristics of contents has been done, inferences are made and conclusions are drawn. For example, a number of researches have done content analysis of TV programs, or textbooks to see how the two genders have been portrayed and presented.

Unobtrusive measures:

These are a form of indirect observation and indirect ways of data collection. **The subjects under study may not be present at the time of investigation. Information is gathered about the lifestyles, behaviors, and habits of the people being studied through indicators present in the surroundings.** Unobtrusive measures may be used as the sole source of evidence, or for supplementing or cross-checking information collected through direct observation.

At times when direct observation is not possible, such measures may replace observation.

Physical Traces are one of the sources of data in unobtrusive measures. Remains, remnants, fragments, objects, and products of past behavior are used as evidence. For example, information regarding the life style of the women of the Indus **Valley civilization can be obtained** by studying the dresses, pieces of jewelry, other bodily adornments, and objects found through excavations and kept in museums.

Products and Use traces:

Cues to the use or nonuse of objects and items can also be used as evidence e.g. wall chalking, or graffiti on walls of educational institutions can be used as indicators of how the people at the concerned locations think about the opposite gender. The products used by people also reveal information about their habits and lifestyles e.g. cosmetic products used by men and women have been noted through a study of garbage cans.

The researchers observed the contents of the area's garbage bins, instead of interviewing the residents.

Archival data or archival research:

Already existing records, documents, different forms of literature, newspaper items, photographs, movies, documentaries, biographies, autobiographies etc are used as evidence or information in this type of research e.g. **using newspaper records to study the**

rate of crime during the past 20 years. Archival data may be used to supplement data gathered through other sources.

Archives are places where data or information are stored. Archives can be public or university libraries, government offices, computerized databases, TV or radio libraries etc.

Experimental Research

Experiment: is the research procedure whereby the variable of interest (independent variable) is manipulated and the effect of this manipulation is studied.

Experimental Research: Experimental Research is the type of research that brings scientific status to psychology. It employs experimental method for finding evidence.

Experimental method: refers to using experimentation for studying a phenomenon.

Experiments are designed carefully in order to have carefully tested findings.

Experimental design: is the plan or structure or lay out of according to which an experiment is conducted.

The main feature of experimentation is **control**.

When do we need to conduct experiments?

Experiments are needed:

- When we have to test hypotheses, or
- When we have to test the impact of a treatment, or program, on behavior
- Experiments are primarily used for investigating cause and effect relationships.

Main components of experimental research:

A hypothesis about the causal relationship

- An independent variable.
- A dependent variable.
- Manipulation of the independent variable.
- Complete control over the dependent variable.

Types of variable involved in an experiment:

Three types of variables are involved in experimental research:

- Independent variable
- Dependent variable
- Control/Intervening or confounding or extraneous variable

Independent: Variable: (IV)

Independent variable is the variable that the researcher hypothesizes to be the causal variable. The impact of IV

is investigated in the experiment. IV is manipulated in terms of kind or level.

Dependent Variable: (DV):

The variable thought to be the consequence or effect of IV. It is the measure of behavior on which the impact

of independent variable is being studied.

Control variable:

A potential independent variable that can have an impact upon the dependent variable; it has to be controlled

so that it does not interfere with findings about the impact of IV.

The logic of Experimental Research:

If there is a cause and effect relationship between the independent and dependent variables, then the manipulation of the independent variable will bring about a change in the value of the dependent variable.

All other variables that can interfere with the findings have to be controlled in order to be sure of the findings.

Groups in a Typical Experiment

- Experimental Group
- Control Group

Experimental Design

- Within- Subjects Design
- Between- Subjects Design

Example of experimental research on gender issues:

Although experimental research is used for investigating gender issues, it is not a method commonly preferred by gender researchers.

Example: The study of the impact of viewing aggressive behavior in cartoons on male and female children:

Two groups of children, one male and one female were allowed to watch a cartoon series containing frequent acts of aggression.

Their baseline level of aggression and indulgence in aggressive behaviors was measured beforehand. The same were measured after the cartoon- viewing phase.

Both groups showed an increase in the expression of aggression.

Advantages of Experimental Research:

- The element of control gives edge to this approach, strengthening the status of psychology a science.
- We can be sure about the cause and effect relationship.

Disadvantages of Experimental Research:

- The subjects may exhibit artificial behavior instead of natural behavior.
- Subjects may experience stress or pressure that may affect their behavior or performance.
- Experiments are expensive, both in terms of time and money.
- Ethical issues: We can not deceive and keep the subjects in dark about reality; but if we disclose the nature and purpose of the experiment it may seriously affect the experimental procedure as well as the findings.

Ex Post Facto Research:

It is a type of Quasi Experimentation, a form of Applied Research. Quasi

Experimentation can be taken as "sort of experimentation", not true experimentation.

Quasi Experiments fit into the experimental framework, although not planned, initiated, or controlled by the experimenter. In such studies the independent variable occurs, or has occurred, naturally and the researcher studies its impact the way it is done in a laboratory experiment.

The difference between the experimental design and ex post facto design:

Experiments involve random assignment of the subjects to the treatment conditions, whereas in ex post facto research only those subjects are chosen who have already been exposed to theory variable under investigation.

Groups in a Quasi- Experiment:

- Exposure group
- Comparison group

Ex Post Facto Studies

Ex post facto research is used when the researchers are interested in studying causal relationship between two variables, but the nature of the phenomenon is such that experimentation is not possible.

For example the impact of isolation for long durations, the behavior of boys brought up as girls, brain damage, impact of high doses of androgens taken accidentally by pregnant mothers, or exposure to harmful drugs or chemical substances.

The subject variable is the characteristic of interest and the readings or scores on a chosen aspect of behavior will be the dependent variable.

Ex post facto research can employ different formats:

Nonequivalent Control Group Design: Two groups are compared, one exposed to the subject variable and the other taken as the control or no-exposure group.

One-group pretest-posttest design: A design in the before- after format i.e., readings or data before exposure are compared with those after exposure. It is a weak design involving problems of accuracy of the pretest data. But at times this is the only resort e.g. when we have to study changes in behavior of acid burn victims, after being burnt

Lesson 06

QUALITATIVE RESEARCH

The type of research in which Information about behavior, in terms of quality rather than in quantity is being looked for. The evidence is also analyzed and reported in qualitative form.

Quantitative versus Qualitative Research:

Quantitative Research:

In quantitative research the data are collected, dealt with, and presented/ reported in the form of numbers. The numbers can be in the form of simple frequencies, percentages, scores, measurements etc. If the phenomenon being explored cannot be recorded in quantities, it is not considered.

The tools of data collection e.g. questionnaires are designed in a way that the researcher ends up with quantifiable Information.

Qualitative Research:

In qualitative research the Information collected is in the form of analytical narratives rather than statistically treatable data. Qualitative methods basically belong to disciplines like Sociology, or Anthropology.

Qualitative research primarily involves:

- In-depth, detailed, case studies
- In-depth interviews
- Basic observational studies

Qualitative or Quantitative Research?

Which of the methods needs to be employed for a research, is not a simple to decide, since the answer to this question may vary at various occasions?

The research method to be employed depends upon:

- The nature of the problem.
- The accessibility of Information.

Using a qualitative- quantitative combination:

Some researchers have used a combination of the two. Walker (1996) adopted this approach in a study. Walker studied if gender differences in the control of a TV remote control would affect the relationships of couples.

She used semi-structured interviews as the main method (quantitative) and supplemented the Information with a qualitative analysis. This analysis was based upon a number of open-ended questions asked to the subjects, and quotes from the interviews. These were used to illustrate the conclusions.

The conclusions of her study showed that when both partners are watching TV, it is men who usually control what is being watched. In general a leisure activity, watching TV, can become a source of conflict.

Limitations Of Quantitative Research:

- In surveys, the researcher depends upon self-reports and not direct observation of phenomenon of interest. Therefore the respondents' honesty, seriousness, accurate memory, and interest in the research determine the accuracy of the findings.
- Co relational research does indicate the existence of a relationship, but gives no clue to the causal relationship.

- Experimental research involves artificiality, and the researcher tends to ignore many behaviors that can be important because they are not thought to be related to the variable of interest.

Qualitative Research Methods

- Case studies
- Ethnography Focus Groups
- Interviews

Case studies

A type of research in which the focus of investigation is a single case or a small sample. This approach is employed in rarely occurring cases, or when getting hold of a large sample is practically not possible.

Rarely occurring condition:

Like cases of brain damage due to accidents, children lost in forests and grown up with animals.

Situations where large samples are not possible:

Like it is difficult to get hold of a large sample of HIV/ AIDS patients, especially females, because doctors do not disclose the identity of their patients and most sufferers do not like to admit that their illness due to a fear of social stigma.

Therefore it will be sufficient if one can get one case each of both genders.

Cases that can be chosen for a case study:

- People who are typical cases of a certain syndrome, treatment regimen, condition, or any other phenomenon, and represent many other people.
- Cases that is unusual or rare.
- Cases that are interesting

Interviews

Interviews are used both in qualitative as well as quantitative research. In depth interviews reveal a lot about the case being studied. Interviews have an edge over questionnaires because of the opportunity to observe non-verbal behavior and body language of the subjects. Willingness of the subjects is an essential requirement of interviews, besides the interviewer's skill and training. When used as the sole source of data, interviews typically contain more open-ended than close-ended questions. For example, interviews of abandoned women, and female victims of domestic violence residing in a shelter home.

Interviews can be conducted in order to:

- Gather oral or life histories and have a broad orientation.
- Investigate specific, narrow, issues or subjects of interest.
- In-depth interviews can be used to supplement case studies.

Conducting Interviews on Gender Issues:

- The following points need to be considered before you decide to employ interviews as your preferred method:
- Sensitive issues need to be tackled carefully. Use carefully selected words, and carefully phrased language.
- Time and place of Interview are very important. Privacy and time suitable to the subjects is should be given priority.
- The people around may matter a lot to the Information yielded by the Interview. Try interviewing in private, or make sure the people present do not interfere.

- For example when Interviewing women in a shelter home, one needs to make sure that the administration or other inmates are not listening without the consent of the interviewee.

Ethnography:

It is one of the methods most **popularly used by anthropologists**. It is gaining popularity among psychologists, especially those studying gender issues. **The researchers spend time in the environment under study**, in events of interest, or with people being observed in such a manner that they get immersed in to the situation. **The researchers become a part of the situation** e.g. a hospital, shelter home, prison, school, or orphanage, and gets the direct and real feel of the context. It is a naturalistic observation that can be supplemented by concealed audio/video recordings of behavior. The researchers record information soon after observations are made.

The researchers have to be particularly careful about not getting emotionally involved with the subjects, or in the situation or behavior. They should also be cautious that their own behavior should in no way alter or reinforce the subjects' behavior or beliefs.

Example of ethnography: Becoming a student to study gender differences in private language of male and female students in a university.

FOCUS GROUPS:

Focus groups are **collective interviews conducted in a group setting**. It is a discussion that revolves around a specific issue. The researcher talks to the participants in order to learn about their opinions, attitudes, preferences, likes or dislikes, and tries to find out reasons/ causes of those. Focus groups are mostly **used as a source of data collection** in surveys but used otherwise as well.

The nature of the subject group can be of one of these types:

- The subjects belonging to different spheres of life are brought together at one location for discussion.
- Subjects with the same background are invited for discussion.

The usual size of the group is 6-8 participants. More people can be added if required, but it **rarely exceeds 12 discussants**. The procedure is the same as interview but focus groups have an advantage in terms of Interviewparticipant/ within-group interaction. Example: We can conduct focus groups to assess gender differences in hurdles faced in choosing the preferred profession by male and female students.

A caution against gender bias in research:

- Researchers should be very careful in selecting the language and words in questionnaires, interview schedules, and other research tools.
- Stereotype about gender, race, color, or other sensitive issues may be perpetuated and reinforced by the careless use of language; it can also cause hurt to the party involved.
- **APA Publication Manual provides guidelines on the use of gender- neutral language, and addresses the issue of language that is considered as sexist, because it implies inequalities between males and females.**
- **In 1977, APA for the first time developed guidelines for “gender- neutral” or nonsexist language.**

The use of gender –neutral language solves two problems:

The problem of designation:

Researchers often intend to refer to all humanity, but use words that imply men alone e.g. “man is curious by nature” or ‘man has to be aware of the health hazards”.

Research shows that even when the researcher was totally nonsexist in approach and intention, the readers took sentences including the word

“man’ or “his” as referring to men alone 86% of the times (Kidd, 1971). Therefore “they” should be used instead of “his” or “her”.

The problem of evaluation:

The terms chosen to describe males and females imply inequality e.g. men’s college and girls’ college, men’s team and girls’ team. Using “women” instead of “girls” can solve the problem.

Choosing an appropriate research design

The following factors need to be kept in mind while designing a research:

- The nature of the problem
- The expected form of Information.
- The preferred form of Information.... Qualitative or quantitative?
- Your skills with numbers and narratives.

Lesson 07

BIOLOGICAL DIFFERENCES BETWEEN GENDERS

Biological differences between males and females are found in three ways:

- In chromosomes
- In hormones
- In structure of the nervous system

Hormones and chromosomes are the:

- Bases of masculinity and femininity
- Structural units and carriers of heredity
- Play important role in various human behaviors

Hormones

Endocrine System is a network of glands that produce and secrete chemical messengers that are called hormones, directly into the blood stream. These glands are controlled by hypothalamus that is important relay station and significant brain structure. **Pituitary glands** (also called master glands) stimulate or hinder secretion of hormones from other glands. Sex and reproduction hormones are called, **Steroid hormones**. Reproductive organs ovaries (in females) and testes (in males) are called **gonads**.

Sexual Differentiation and role of Chromosomes:

Sexual dimorphism is the condition where the sexes of the same species exhibit different characteristics, particularly characteristics not directly involved in reproduction. The process of sexual differentiation starts when formation takes place. Chromosomes are threadlike structures that are structural carriers of heredity, play very important role in sex differentiation. In human beings there are 23 pairs of chromosomes. At the time of conception half amount of chromosomes is received from mother side and half from father side. 23rd pair of chromosome is called sex chromosome in females it is XX and in males it is XY. Genes contain genetic information carried on chromosomes. Researchers claim that XY chromosomal makeup may not be as stable as XX and therefore play a role in higher mortality rates for men. XX chromosomal makeup and the hormone estrogen seem to make women less vulnerable to physical problems so women live longer lives.

Sex Chromosomal Abnormalities:

Sudden structural changes in the genes are called mutations. These mutations lead to negative consequences in individual's development. Sometimes deleted or duplicated number of chromosomes also causes abnormalities in an individual. Researchers have found that disorders in sex chromosomes lead to problems in gender role development, intelligence, growth and hormone production.

Female Sex Chromosome Abnormalities:

Turner's syndrome:

This syndrome occurs when individual inherit only one X chromosome and their sex chromosomal structure is XO.

- Such cases are females in sex with abnormal growth patterns. They are short in height, averaging 4 foot 7 inches as adults
- Often have distinctive webbed necks (i.e., extra folds of skin)
- Small jaws
- They generally lack prominent female reproduction ability.

- They have exceptionally small, widely spaced breasts, broad shield-shaped chests, and turned-out elbows.
- Their ovaries do not develop normally and they do not ovulate.
- They also have a higher than average incidence of thyroid disease.
- In some individuals, there is slight mental retardation.

Turner's syndrome is rare. Current estimates of its frequency range from 1 in 3,000 female infants to 1 in 5,000.

If diagnosed in early childhood, regular injections of human growth hormones can increase their height by a few inches. Beginning around the normal age of puberty, **estrogen replacement therapy can result in some breast development and menstruation.** These treatments allow Turner's syndrome women to appear relatively normal.

Metafemales or triple-X females:

Such females inherit three X chromosomes. Their chromosomal structure is XXX. As adults, these "superfemales" are usually an inch or so taller than average with unusually long body structure. They have normal development of sexual characteristics and are fertile. They may have slight learning difficulties and are usually in the low range of normal intelligence. They tend to be emotionally immature for their size during childhood. This type of chromosomal abnormality is less rare than Turner syndrome.

Male Sex Chromosome Abnormalities:

Klinefelter syndrome:

Individual with this syndrome inherit on extra X chromosome and their chromosomal structure is XXY. They characteristically have relatively high-pitched voices, feminine body contours as well as breast enlargement, and comparatively little facial and body hair.

They are sterile or nearly so, and their testes and prostate glands are small. As a result, they produce relatively small amounts of testosterone. The feminizing effects of this hormonal imbalance can be significantly diminished if Klinefelter syndrome boys are regularly given testosterone from the age of puberty on.

Klinefelter syndrome men are an inch or so above average height. They also are likely to be overweight. They usually have learning difficulties as children, especially with language and short-term memory. If not given extra help in early childhood, this often leads to poor school grades and a subsequent low self esteem. Klinefelter syndrome is not diagnosed until they are tested for infertility. Klinefelter syndrome males with more than two X chromosomes usually have extreme symptoms and are often mentally retarded.

XYY syndrome:

The individual with this abnormality receive extra Y chromosome and their chromosomal structure is XYY. As adults, these "super-males" are usually tall (above 6 feet) and generally appear and act normal. However, they produce high levels of testosterone. During adolescence, they often are slim, have severe facial acne, and are poorly coordinated. They are usually fertile and lead ordinary lives as adults. Majority remain unaware that they have a chromosomal abnormality.

Early studies of XYY syndrome done in European prisons initially led to the erroneous conclusion that these men were genetically predisposed to antisocial, aggressive behavior, below average intelligence, and homosexuality. Contributing to the early view that XYY syndrome men have serious personality disorders.

However, some researchers suggest that the high testosterone levels of XYY men can make them somewhat more prone to violence and that this may cause higher rates of wife beating.

Sex Differentiation in Reproductive System

X and Y chromosomes determine the sex of child being male or female. Both sexes have two sex-related internal systems:

Wolffian system: The system with a capacity to develop into the male internal reproductive system.

Mullerian system: The system with a capacity to develop into the female internal reproductive system.

Sex development is almost the same for both sexes during the first six weeks of prenatal development & both systems exist in both sexes.

External sex organ development starts after six weeks of conception. But these organs are not differentiated at this stage and further external sex development depends upon the amount of **androgen** and **estrogen** hormones. Androgen & estrogen hormones are gonadal hormones. Both sexes produce these two hormones.

But in males' **androgens** and in females **estrogens** are in greater proportions. Testosterone is androgen and estradiol is common estrogen. Progesterone is another gonadal hormone that play important role in females during pregnancy.

The production of **androgen** hormone is determined by Y chromosome in males that stimulates sexual reproductive system.

Production of Testosterone (androgen) stimulates **Wolffian system** and degenerates the **Mullerian system** that results in development of internal reproductive organs.

In female fetus X chromosome stimulate **estrogen** hormone that further leads to **Mullerian system** development and degeneration of **Wolffian system**, which results in the development of female internal reproductive organs. During prenatal development androgen & estrogen are very important for the development of sex characteristics in both sexes.

During infancy and childhood gonadal hormones are produce in low quantities but during puberty these hormones secretions increased and develop sexual maturity. Growth hormones are released from Pituitary in adolescence play important role in muscular and bones development. Pituitary glands also release follicle stimulating hormone (FSH) and lutenizing hormone (LH) that is involve in production of androgen and estrogen hormones. In males testosterone is released by testes that are endocrine glands. It stimulates the maturation of sex organs, production of sperms and prepare for reproduction. In females estrogen hormones play important role in **menarche (menstrual cycle)**; beginning of menstruation and ovulation. **Progesterone** hormone secreted in females; controls menstrual cycle and significant during pregnancy.

Hormonal influences in both sexes:

Endocrine glands are the vital glands that release chemical substances, called hormones, into the bloodstream. Hormones thus circulate throughout the body. Different organs are sensitive to different hormones. The impact of hormones produces different actions at different locations.

Hormones directly related to sex differences and reproduction, are known as steroid hormones.

Gonads: The reproductive organs, testes in males and ovaries in females, related to the steroid hormones. The hypothalamus and the pituitary gland are the main brain structures that regulate the production of sex hormones.

Hypothalamus causes the production of **Releasing hormones**. Gonadotropin- releasing hormone is one of these hormones.

Gonadotropin- releasing hormone has active influence on the pituitary; as a result of this action, the pituitary releases a number of other hormones. The release of Tropic hormones results from this action.

Gonadotropins are one of these. Circulating through the bloodstream these hormones impact the testes and ovaries, which are subsequently stimulated to produce their respective hormones. In males' **androgens**, and in females' **estrogens**, are in greater proportions.

Testosterone is an androgen and **estradiol** is a common estrogen.

Progesterone is another gonadal hormone that plays an important role in females during pregnancy.

A number of hormones other than steroid hormones are also involved, directly or indirectly, in reproduction and related processes. Smaller and larger quantities of hormones affect several behaviors. For example **testosterone** levels can affect performance on some tests. Women with high levels of testosterone perform better on three-dimensional tasks than women with low levels do, but men with low levels outperform men with high levels. Females exposed to more quantities of androgen are tending to have behavioral characteristic like males.

Study (Dabbs, 2000) revealed that individuals with high testosterone levels are associated with lower status professions as high testosterone levels are related to impulsiveness and antisocial behavior. Comparative study of college students and young men delinquents revealed that they have higher levels of testosterone. Another study of male prisoners also revealed that high testosterone levels are associated with deferent types of violence including sex and rule violations. As female also produce testosterone so, various studies have conducted to find out relationship between testosterone and female behaviors. Results support hypothesis that high testosterone is related to aggressive behaviors.

Hormonal Abnormalities:

Adrenogenital Syndrome

Excessive prenatal production of **androgen** from adrenal glands causes this syndrome. In male fetus it doesn't cause major problems. But in female fetus this results in birth of female with physical structure resembling boys. Increased androgen levels not only affect physical characteristics behavior is also affected. Sometimes surgeons recommend surgery for correction of external genitalia. This syndrome also influence play activities of girl child. Berenbaum & Snyder, (1995) stated that girls with such syndrome are more likely to be "tomboys".

Androgen Insensitivity Syndrome:

Found in normal XY male fetus with body cells insensitive to androgens.

Cause: abnormal functioning of androgen receptors.

Individuals with this syndrome have XY chromosomal structure.

But inability of androgen receptors does not allow the proper development masculine characteristics. At the same time they have internal male reproductive organs as the Mullerian-inhibiting substance is present.

Inability of androgen receptors does not allow the proper development of male reproductive structures, that requires a degeneration of the Mullerian system and the development of Wolffian system. Such babies appear to be girls at the time of birth. Such individuals have been found to have gender identity, behavior and appearance of females (Hines, Ahmed & Hughes, 2003).

Sex Differentiation in Nervous System:

Men and women differ not only in their physical attributes and reproductive function but also in many other characteristics, including the way they solve intellectual problems. Studies reflect that the effect of sex hormones on brain organization starts parentally. Sex differentiation of human brain is mostly dependent on the prenatal exposure to androgen (testosterone). First gender difference exists in size of the brain. Males have larger brain size than females. The area in the brain that regulates female and male reproductive behavior is the hypothalamus. This tiny structure at the base of the brain connects to the pituitary, the master endocrine gland.

It has been shown that a region of the hypothalamus is visibly larger in male rats than in females and that this size difference is under hormonal control.

Researches have shown that men's left side of brain is more developed that is responsible for conventionally logical thought, abstract and analytic thinking. Women's right side of brain is more developed that is responsible for imaginative, artistic activity, holistic & intuitive thinking, visual and spatial tasks. Studies have also revealed that women have superiority on tasks needed memory. These differences can be revealed from following studies examples:

Average men perform better than women at certain spatial tasks. They also outperform women in mathematical reasoning tests. Men exhibit more accuracy in tests of target-directed motor skills.

Average women excel on tests that measure recall of words and on tests that challenge the person to find words that begin with a specific. They also tend to be better than men at rapidly identifying matching items and performing certain precision manual tasks, such as placing pins in designated holes on a board etc.

The Psychological Perspectives about Gender Development and Gender Differences Gender development refers to the process of identifying oneself as being male or female, and gender roles are expected, and set, thinking and behavior patterns for males and females.

Highlighted by Buzybee

Lesson 08

THEORIES OF GENDER DEVELOPMENT

Theories of Gender Development:

Psychological theories that study, describe, understand, explain, and predict the development of gender roles, stereotypes, gender differentiation and other related issues.

Nature and Nurture

Nature: Refers to hereditary influences, and **nurture** means environmental influences.

Both influences are essential and are mutually influential. For example children's response to parenting an (environmental influence) is determined by children's temperament and other inherited characteristics e.g., physical condition. Development and expression of hereditary characteristics is also affected by environmental influences.

There are at least eight different theories in psychology that explain gender development:

1. The Biological Approach
2. The Behavior Approach
3. Observational Learning Approach
4. The Cognition Approach
5. The Psychoanalytic Approach
6. Humanistic Approach
7. The Socio cultural Approach
8. The Epigenetic Approach

The Biological Approach:

Emphasizes on biological processes and constitution that cause physical differences between men and women. Males and females have different sets of chromosomal make up. Human beings have 23 pairs of chromosomes. The 23rd pair of chromosomes is called sex chromosomes: in females it is XX and in males it is XY. Therefore men and women are born with different genetic patterns. How this genetic pattern will express itself will depend upon the action of hormones. Certain hormones affect the development of physical sex characteristics. According to biological theory differences in chromosomes (X/Y) and hormones (testosterone/estrogen) determine the behavioral differences between boys and girls. Androgen hormones are related to male characteristics. The most important androgen is testosterone. The androgens have a very vital role in determining prenatal physical development. The absence of androgens means the fetus will develop female characteristics and the presence means the fetus will develop male characteristics.

Biological Differences in Brain

Men's left side of brain is more developed that is responsible for conventionally logical thought, abstract and analytic thinking. Women's right side of brain is more developed that is responsible for imaginative, artistic activity, holistic & intuitive thinking, visual and spatial tasks.

This approach attributes the development of gender roles to biological processes but also acknowledge the importance of cultural differences, cognitive processes and sex-stereotypes.

The Behavioral Approach

According to this approach all **behavior and personality is a result of learning**. Where the biological approach emphasizes "nature", the behavioral approach stresses upon "nurture". Early behaviorists, like Skinner, emphasized the importance of reinforcement

Later on, in addition to reward and punishment, the significance of other variables like the social context, observation, modeling, and imitation were also included in behaviorism, that led to the social learning approach

According to the behavioral approach, learning of gender roles can be explained in terms of a result of:

- Classical conditioning
- Operant Conditioning or the use of reinforcement: positive, negative, punishment, or no reinforcement
- Learning by observation

The behaviorists maintain that gender –role associated behaviors are learnt and not innate, just like any other cultural patterns. They are shaped by reinforcement (Guerin, 1992).

Children's upbringing is designed in such a way that they are steered toward learning specific, socially desired gender roles. Children, right from birth, receive different treatment

This difference may increase in later years in childhood and can be seen in childcare settings, as well as in home. The very fact that we can find variations in gender roles across cultures indicates the existence of different treatments

But if different treatments are the cause of gender differences then how did this difference start in first place?

Can it be that there were small innate differences that were amplified after different treatment?

Classical Conditioning

Every time a child sees the parent of the same sex as his/her own, he/she is seen as wearing a particular type of clothes, using fixed type of gestures, and using a particular style of communication. This forms a type of association which leads to adoption of gender roles. But a stronger and more plausible explanation is the one based upon operant conditioning.

Operant Conditioning

The type of learning in which a voluntary response becomes stronger or weaker depending on its positive or negative consequences. The organism plays an active role and 'operates' on environment to produce the desired outcome. Now why would an organism operate on the environment? To meet, as well as avoid, certain consequences-----reinforcement in other words.

 Positive Reinforcement Dog's behavior causes a good thing to happen. Behavior increases. 	Negative Reinforcement R- Dog's behavior causes a bad thing to stop. Behavior increases. 
+P  Dog's behavior causes a bad thing to happen. Behavior decreases. Positive Punishment	 P- Dog's behavior causes a good thing to stop. Behavior decreases. Negative Punishment

The Cognitive Approach

The Cognitive approach focuses upon the thought processes underlying learning. It gives importance to cognition when understanding and explaining behavior. This theory gives importance to the internal states of the person as well as the environmental events; however it is the thinking and perception that is the key factor.

The term cognition refers to "knowledge" as well as "the process of knowing" Cognitive approach emphasizes:

- Thoughts
- Feelings
- Thinking
- Values
- Expectations etc
- How people will perceive the world, and how these perceptions will be acted upon.

The Cognitive Approach to Gender Roles

- The theory proposes the **interaction of mental schema** and **social experience** in directing gender role behavior.
- The cognitive approach **focuses upon the child's "understanding"**.
- **Gender schema (plural schemata or schemas) is a mental framework that organizes and guides a child understands of information relevant to gender.** Example: information about which toys are for girls and which toys are for boys forms schema that guides behavior
- Example: If a child has seen women being respected in his family, he will perceive women as a respectable being; and if he has seen women being battered and maltreated he will perceive them as some low grade creature.

Lawrence Kohlberg's Cognitive Development Theory: The concept of Gender Constancy:

Children understand gender just as they understand anything else.

Children have experiences with people of both genders, they think about their experiences, having made sort of mental notes of what males and females do, and adopt behaviors performed by people of their own sex.

Children do their own gender typing themselves. They make classifications of themselves and of others as male or female, and organize their behaviors around that classification. The gender roles that children adopt are organized around this classification. Behaviors consistent with their own gender are adopted. This is reflected in their use of language, clothes, toys etc. According to Kohlberg, acquisition of gender roles results from gender constancy i.e., a child's understanding and awareness that his/ her sex is permanent, constant, and will never change. **Gender constancy is also known as sex category Constancy in modern literature.**

Gender appropriate behaviors are adopted after the realization that sex is a permanent feature of personality.

Gender constancy is not a phenomenon that occurs at once, at one point in time. It takes place in three stages

1. **Gender identity:** Age 2-3 years; Becoming **aware of one's own gender**, and that of others.
2. **Gender stability:** Realization of **boys and girls that they will grow up** as men or women respectively, i.e., **gender is a fixed, permanent**, quality and an integral feature of their personality. But at this stage they understand this on the basis of superficial, external appearances, and stereotyped behaviors.
3. **Gender Consistency:** The **awareness that gender remains** the same no **matter what one wears, how one behaves, whatever hairstyle one has.**

Although Kohlberg put forth the concept of gender constancy as a significant theme, there is not much solid research evidence supporting it. Different researches have yielded findings quite different from, and even contrary to, Kohlberg's hypothesis that gender constancy stage is the point where children actually learn gender roles and relevant appropriate behaviors. **It has been seen that at 2 ½ years of age children begin to prefer the company of children of their own sex.**

Also, girls are more interested in dolls and boys in cars. Long before attaining the stage of gender constancy, children exhibit gender- typed preferences. Children can categorize activities and objects by gender, know a lot about what males and females do, and often acquire gender appropriate behaviors. Five- year old boys having reached gender constancy, or almost there, pay more attention to male characters on TV and watch more sports and action programs in comparison to other age mates. Children tend to develop more complex beliefs about gender later on; also they tend to become more flexible in their views about gender roles

Gender Schema Theory:

“A schema is a mentally organized network of gender- related Information that influences behavior” Gender schema is a mental framework that organizes and guides a child understands of information relevant to gender. For example information about which toys are for girls and which toys are for boys form schema that guides behavior .According to gender schema theory, children first develop a simplified concept of male –female distinctions and later on apply it universally.

First of all children learn what sex they are. Then they develop a concept of what it means to be male or female in their culture, and on the basis of the development of this concept they begin to take on gender roles.

Whatever observations they have of men and women, they organize those around the gender schema that they have formed as a result of their observation of how their society classifies behaviors as male and female including clothes and toys etc.

For example a child observes that it is always the mother who cooks, and the father is always the one who fixes electrical appliances and faults. Gradually he develops the concept that household chores are meant to be done by the mother (woman), and tougher tasks are handled by the father (man). This leads to the assimilation of other similar ideas and perceptions, a realization that men are strong and women weak. If the father has to cook on a rare occasion, it doesn't match with the “all in control schema of the father” and the child notes this discrepancy. Gender schemata influence judgments about behavior thus promoting gender stereotypes.

The gradual process of development of gender schema:

Stage	Age	Description
Gender identification	2-3.5 years	Children believe it is possible to change sex by wearing clothes of opposite sex. Can identify household gender stereotypes: (mechanical tools used by father and the mother works in kitchen). Gender labeling is learned.
Gender stability	3.5-4.5 years	Sex is stable over time, not situations. Older peers and siblings are models for social learning of gender roles. Boys may play with the toys socially labeled as girl's toys but do not own them ultimately. Child applies labels to self and others, but they may be inconsistent
Gender consistency	4.5-7 years	Sex is stable. Children value and imitate same sex behaviors. This leads to development of gender appropriate attributes

Slaby and Frey (1975): children with gender consistency attend more to the same-sex model. Children use cognitive processes to choose appropriate gender-related behaviors. Cognitive theory argues that gender behavior is learnt by viewing others' behavior through social learning process

Learning of Gender Roles by Preschoolers

Preschoolers do have an idea of gender roles, but their cognitive experiences are simple, not complex. They see things in simpler terms i.e., at concrete level. They see males and females as total opposites, as they judge things on their appearance and face value. Past experiences have not yet integrated into their existing schema. Preschoolers' cognitive patterns are selfish and still. Children develop a simplified concept of male- female distinctions and then apply it universally. Children form a script describing what the various gender roles should be, and then intellectually follow that script **Children fit their cognitive experiences into the script they have.** If their experiences are vague, ambiguous, or contradictory, then preschoolers look for the script. In a study children were given gender –neutral, unfamiliar toys. Initially they tried to find out and decide if they were meant for boys or girls. Then they made a decision considering which ones they wanted to play with or not (Martin et al., 1995).

The Concept of Self- socialization

Children are the heroes in their own gender role socialization, and act as active agents.

Self- socialization is a three- step process:

- Around **ages 5-6**, children learn to classify themselves as males or females, and sex **as a permanent quality is recognized**
- Children are motivated by this **self- categorization** to value characteristics and **behaviors associated with their sex**
- They try to bring their own behavior at participant with the behaviors considered gender appropriate in their culture. (Geis, 1993).
So children identify and note gender behaviors, identify and note their gender identity, and make effort to remove disparities between the two.

Piaget's stages of cognitive development and development of gender roles

Stage	Age	Description
Preoperational Stage	2-4 years	Thinking is concrete, not logical , judges on appearance. Gender labeling Uses cues such as dress, hair, Can change sex if appearance is made different. Develop categories associated with sex/gender. Identify them as male or female. Use stereotypes as rules
Concrete operational Stage	7-12 years	Thinking is logical , but limited to concrete Cognitive understanding of stability of gender develops
Formal Operational stage	12 year- adulthood	Thinking is scientifically logical , can be applied to intellectual concepts. Adolescents become more rigid in sex-typing

Is the Cognitive Approach the Only Best approach?

This approach has ignored the role of biological factors that are involved in developing cognitive schema Cultural differences in forming gender roles are not addressed

Highlighted by Buzybee

Lecture 12

THEORIES OF GENDER DEVELOPMENT (3)

The Psychodynamic Approach

- ☐ Psychodynamic approach is based on Freud's theory of psychosexual development
- ☐ Family dynamics influence individuals at a subconscious level and this leads to the development of internal gender identities.

Gender Development: Freudian Perspective

Psychosexual stages of development take place with possibility of particular conflicts at different stages. Gender roles develop as a result of resolution process of conflict at phallic stage. Feelings of rivalry and hatred develop against the father at this stage. The father is seen as stronger and unconquerable; this leads to a conflict. The defense mechanism of identification is used for resolving the conflict. This gender identification leads to sex-typed behavior and development of gender roles. Absence of a parent, particularly, the same-sex parent affects the normal process of gender development. Stevenson & Black (1988): boys with absent fathers around the oedipal stage show less sex-typed behavior

Gender Development Karen Horney's Perspective

She re-examined some of Freud's basic concepts. She remained within the psychoanalytic paradigm, and accepted the role of unconscious as a driving force.

- She digressed from Freud on gender differences in personality development.
- She differed from Freud on the concept of jealousy in females, their feelings of inferiority, and masculinity complex; whereby females express masculine attitudes and behavior.
- She also differed on Freud's emphasis on early childhood experiences, and the significance that he attached to the role of biological forces.
- She argued that the envy that females have against males, was symbolic, and did not emerge out of a desire to physically match them; instead it represented a desire to attain the social prestige and position that men enjoy. Horney emphasized upon the significance of social forces. She hypothesized that men envy women's ability to reproduce i.e., womb envy. According to Horney, men seek and struggle for, achievement because they are trying to overcompensate for the lack of ability to reproduce. In comparison to women, men feel inadequate, and as a result they attribute evil to women. In order to deal with their feeling of inferiority, men need to feel more adequate, for which they see women as inferior. Men's feelings of resentment result in attempts to weaken women and leave women with feelings of inferiority and insecurity.
- Unlike Freud, Horney believed that females' inferiority had origin in male insecurity; she disagreed from Freud over the idea that females feel inferior because of a perceived physical inferiority. It is men's behavior, and a society with masculine bias that generates females' inferiority.

Contemporary Psychodynamic Theories

The feminist thought affected the Freudian school of thought as well.

Psychoanalytic Feminism

- Roots in the work of Freud
- Gender is not a biologically determined phenomenon
- Psychosexual development leads to the gender role that we adopt and play.

- Childhood experiences are responsible for making the male believe that he is masculine and a female believe that she is feminine. These experiences lead to gender inequality. This situation is a result of a male dominated society.
- Nancy Chodorow (1979), a sociologist, and Ellyn Kaschak (1992), a psychologist, developed their versions of the psychodynamic thought, which is quite different from the traditional Freudian approach.

Nancy Chodorow's Theory:

Chodorow (1979) focuses on early childhood experiences with mothers.

She described pre-oedipal stage where children identify with their mothers. Girl child keeps association with mother to become feminine.

Chodorow (1979), shared with Freud, pessimism about gender equality. She, like Freud, was pessimistic about any potential equality between men and women. However she departed from him on the root cause of inequality.

As opposed to the Freudian emphasis on males' and females' perception of anatomical differences, she believed in the impact of children's early experiences with their mothers. She proposed the idea of the significance of the pre-oedipal period that occurs in early childhood, prior to the onset of Oedipus complex.

She also proposed that the course of personality development for males and females was different. What is significant is the fact that most, if not all, children are mothered by a woman.

Women alone do not have the ability of infant-care; however most nurturing is provided by mothers/women, whereas little caring is done by fathers/ men. The bonding between mothers and children in early childhood has a deep imprinted effect on the children. This effect, however, is different for the male and the female child. An infant's world is centered on the mother. The mother-son relationship is not as close as the mother-daughter relationship; mothers and daughters are closer since they are of the same sex. The infants are unaware of the sex differences, but the mother is; and she is the one who treats the male and female children differently.

A perception of gender differences starts emerging when children begin to develop a sense of self. This process is easier for the female child, since she has already identified with the mother, and now this identification has to get only stronger. However the boys have a tougher task at hand. Having lived in a mother-centered world, and having already identified with her, they have to develop an identity separate from the mother. The male child has to face separation from mother in order to develop his gender identity and to become masculine. The development of self or identity in boys involves separation from the mother; and a rejection of their mother's femininity. The gender similarity between mothers and daughters, and their difference from sons affects emotional closeness.

Researches has confirmed that sons and daughters are different in emotional closeness (Benenson, Morash, & Petrakos, 1998). When the boys have to separate themselves from mothers in order to develop an identity of their own, it has deep effects on their personality. They tend to reject all femininity, and develop a fear and mistrust of the feminine (Chodorow, 1978). The development of a sense of self in girls, and growing into womanhood, is smooth and non-turbulent; they have a close relationship with their mothers. Their early relationship with the mothers is reproduced when they themselves are mothering their children. According to Chodorow, the effort on part of boys to distinguish and separate themselves from mothers, results into the worldwide denigration of women by men (Brannon, 2004).

Antigone Phase: Kaschak's Theory

Kaschak has borrowed the character of Antigone from Sophocles' Greek plays; just like Freud borrowed the character of Oedipus. Antigone was Jocasta's and Oedipus's daughter. Antigone was Oedipus's care taker, companion, and guide, after Oedipus destroyed his eyes. Antigone devoted her life and freedom to the care of her father, and sacrificed for him; Oedipus the height of her devotion as his right. Kaschak used the same scenario to explain the personality development and make up of men and women. He acknowledges the usefulness of the application of the legend of Oedipus in Freudian theory, but disagrees with the way he treated women in his concept of female Oedipus complex. Antigone represents a typical good daughter in a patriarchal family.

Societies, in which men are born, grown, and developed, grant power to them in the society as well as in their families. As part of this system and process, men take women as their possession. Women on the other hand are born and developed in such a manner that they consider themselves as men's possession. Their position is always that of subservience to men; and this is reflected in their personality make up and life.

"As Oedipus' dilemma became a symbol for the dilemma of the son, so might that of Antigone be considered representative of the inevitable fate of the good daughter in the patriarchal family" (Kaschak, 1992). It is not possible for many men and women to resolve these conflicts because the societies are formed and structured in such a manner that they maintain a constant state of male power and autonomy on one hand, and female subservience on the other.

As a consequence, men treat women not as independent people, but as extensions of themselves. Men want gain power, and they do it in a self-centered manner; this may end up in causing harm to others, especially women, by means of family violence and other such behaviors. In a research on family violence, Johnson (1995) concluded that the cause underlying indulgence of some men in family violence is the feeling that they have a right to do so. For a normal course of personality development, women should resolve the Antigone phase. But if they fail in doing so, then they "allow themselves to be extensions of others rather than striving for independence". This situation may result into the development of self-hatred, or shame. In such cases women may develop a need to establish form relationships with others so that a feeling of self-worth is attained.

Lecture 13 Other Approaches

The Humanistic Approach

This approach is based on Roger's theory that does not directly explain the process of gender role development. Deals self and conditional positive regard are the main concepts in this regard.

Roger's theory In the process of gender development conditional positive regard can be seen as a set of expectations for gender roles, and ideal self can be understood as gender appropriate behavior to achieve positive regard gender appropriate behavior becomes an ideal self for an individual

Like boys are told that cooking is for girls, in the same way we can portray cultural stereotype as conditional positive regard for individuals and to achieve this regard he/she develop concept of ideal self that results in his/her gender appropriate behavior This approach not directly explains the process of gender development so no research data is found from this perspective

Cultural Influences

Technological advanced have affected the societies in following ways:

- Women are transferred to the less influential social sphere of home

- Men are associated with the public sphere of politics, economy, etc.
- Women are fighting for becoming independent Archeology

Feminine role is defined as subordinate to the masculine role

- ☐ In non-industrialized countries males are considered self-reliant and achievers
- ☐ Women are regarded as responsible, obedient
- ☐ The Western stereotypes for men and women are:
 - Men to be instrumental (assertive, competitive, independent)
 - Women to be expressive (co-operative, supportive, sensitive)

Some Gender Role Stereotypes

Male Attributes

Acts as a leader

Aggressive

Ambitious

Dominant

Forceful

Independent

Female Attributes

Compassionate

Gentle

Loves children

Sensitive to needs of others

Tender

Understanding

Conclusion

Development of gender-roles is a positive factor for socialization and adjustment process of an individual

There are also some cultural differences, though the stereotypes of females being nurturing and males being instrumental are very widespread across culture

Gender differences may be accounted for by a range of biological, social, and cognitive factors

Lecture 14

Gender Typing and Stereotyping

Sex-Typing

Sex-typing is process of categorizing men and women on the bases of some traits. Despite of cultural differences we find some similarities in traits. For example women are thought to be sensitive, weak, dependent and men are associated with the traits of adventurous and determined in most of the cultures.

The term gender and sex are used interchangeably. The word sex gives biological affect whereas social scientists prefer to use term gender because of its socio-psychological connotation.

Development of Sex-typing

Development of sex-typing starts with sex-identity that is sense of being male or female, mostly children acquire this identity at the age of 3 years. Researches have found that sex-identity changes with the age and experiences; according to socio-psychological phenomenon development of sex-typing takes place during late childhood. In early childhood differences in hair styles, clothes and toys aid in child's concept of sex-identity, whereas in later childhood sex stereotypes are learned through imitation and observational learning; what other people act, feel, behave or think. Mostly at the age of five children can associate certain traits like brave or weak with man and women or they are able to separate tools or things used by both sexes.

Social scientists present two models about development of gender-typed stereotypes.

- According to first model gender characteristics like physical appearance or gender biased activities are learnt in earlier childhood as they do not involve abstract concepts and personality traits about activities and occupations developed in later childhood because of need perceptual variations.
- Second model emphasize the presence of cues and gender biased activities that aids understanding of personality traits stereotypes in earlier childhood. Gender stereotypes are broad categories that reflect our beliefs about males and females. Parents, peer group, schools and cultural norms are important factors that plays important role in development of sex-typing.

Sex-Roles

Sex-roles are expected set of thinking and behavior patterns for males and females. A group of social scientists take development of gender-roles as positive factor for socialization and adjustment process of individual. Others opine that gender-identity minimize the use of individual potential and abilities considering not suitable for their sex. They view that sex-typing stereotypes also affect the process of self-exploration, especially in case of women.

Theorists concerned with women issues consider same sex-type stereotypes for females throughout the world and consider gender-roles natural and inflexible. In 1930's Mead studied three cultures in New Guinea and found out different sex-typed behaviors for women and supported hypothesis that human nature is flexible and changeable. But biological bases of behavior cannot be ignored.

Some Sex Stereotyped Behaviors for Males and Females

Males	Females
Brave	Emotional
Autocrat	Sentimental
Independent	Fragile
Dominant	Dependent
Aggressive	Submissive

Theories of Sex-Typing

Several theories are presented to find out the cause of sex-role development.

Psycho-analytical Theories: Freud view that sex-typing is natural process due to biological differences of male and female. This approach explains that child identifies with the parent of same sex. Psycho-analytical approach focus on biological differences and view first five years of and individual important for personality development. Freud gave psycho-sexual stages of development and proposed that healthy resolution of tensions at each stage result in healthy personality and identification with the parent of same sex; in this way gender-roles are learnt as process of socialization.

Social Learning Theory emphasizes that individual's gender development is process of observational learning and imitation, modeling and reward and punishment guide a child towards gender appropriate and inappropriate behavior. Social stereotypes, cultural norms and agents of socialization (parents, peer, teacher and institutions) play important role in development of gender identity and sex-typing. But this approach ignores the importance of individual cognitive abilities, inheritance and development stages and treat individual a passive object to respond for environment.

Cognitive Development Theory explains that child develops the concept of being male or female first and then gender behaviors are learnt. They view that sex identity is facilitated by people around child but it is not imitation. This model believes that child develops permanent cognitive category for his/herself as being male or female at the age of 4 to 6 years, after that sex-roles are adopted. This theory is criticized because it ignores cultural aspects.

Cerebral Lateralization Theory explains the there is difference in the cerebral hemispheres of both male and female. In females left hemisphere is developed earlier that is responsible for their active language faculties and males acquire mathematical and analytical abilities earlier due to early development of right hemisphere.

Factors Influencing Sex-Typing

Sex-typing occurs at both intentional and unintentional level. At unintentional level biological determinants play role and intentional level is affected by psycho-Social determinants.

Biological Determinant of Sex-Typing

The first determinant of being male or female is biological. Chromosomes are structural units of heredity and carry genetic information. In human beings there are 23 pairs of chromosomes. 23rd pair of chromosome is called sex chromosome in females it is XX and in males it is XY. Only females can bear child, and these biological differences lead towards different sex-type stereotypes.

Psycho-Social Determinants of Sex-Typing

Socialization

Socialization is a process of learning sex-roles from different agents of society. Firstly parents and family are important agents that guide child in sex-typing and identification with same sex. Their different behavior with girl and boy develops gender identity. Secondly cultural sex-

stereotypes also aid in identifying process. Gender role can vary according to the social group to which a person belongs or he/she identifies. For example in all over the world women share the stereotype of being coward and weepy.

Sex-typing is very rigid in first 5 years of individual because girls and boys receive different treatments from the society. Sex-typing is flexible and with the passage of time when child acquire cognitive development sex-roles are learnt and changed.

Family

Family is most **important of agent of socialization** and sex-typing. Family members are responsible for fulfilling physical and psychological needs. Child receives inheritance from family and it guides for social, emotional development. Family provides basic knowledge of sex-typing and teaches cultural sex-stereotypes.

In cultures like Pakistan extended family members (grandparents, uncle & aunts) also influence the process of sex-typing.

Parents

Parents are responsible for **transmitting their own sex-roles** and stereotypes to their child.

Parents' verbal and non-verbal gestures and selection of toys, colors and play activities for boy and girl develop concept of sex-typing. Positive encouragement or extra support from parents can develop opposite sex stereotype in girl or boy, for example girl can be more assertive or boy can take more interest in cooking or household activities.

Schools

Schools are significant institutions for sex-typing especially early perceptions about individuals and things influence the decisions of later life. **Teacher's behavior, style of punishment and different play activities with boys and girls facilitates sex-typing.** Schooling is threat for the child at beginning as he/she has to leave mother. So, in most of the countries nursery teaching is associated with females that provides substitute of mother to the students.

Childhood Play

Childhood **play activities start in pre-school years and share stereotypes and sex-typing,** socialized by parents and family. Role of childhood play in sex-typing depends on the school environments. Schools where boys and girls are stressed sex stereotypes, sex-typing is developed earlier but institutions where child are allowed to play according to their interest and cognitive abilities boys or girls can enjoy any kind of play (dolls house or boxing).

Language

Peers

Peer groups develop at the age of six or seven when schooling starts and generally **same sex groups are formed.** Peer influences style of conversation, play activities, ideas and religious activities. Peer approval force child to adopt sex-biased behaviors in case of same sex peer group.

Social Discrimination

In socialization process of Pakistani culture females are generally victim of sex discrimination. Socialization is affected by Lullabies and marriage practices. **Lullabies are practices that promote cultural norms and values.** In Pakistani culture these lullabies promote negative or weaker position of females than males. Women are given inferior status and males are considered symbol of pride and power for the family.

Women are thought to be custodian of family's honor and they are sacrificed for ending family disputes or property matters in Hindko, Brahvi, Pashto and Bloch lullabies, whereas males share the status of power and personal glory. These practices promote sex-discrimination, negative

stereotypes and inferior concept of gender-identity. When girl or boy sees his/her mother and father singing these lullabies, negative sex-identities for females are developed.

Mass Media

Media is not only source of communication or entertainment; it also plays a vital role in projecting cultural norms and values, and sex-typed behavior. In Pakistani media women are portrayed as passive, economically reliant on men and having no information about the world outside home or national progress and international affairs. Media has been depicting women concerning about family matters or house hold cores. After and during 90's media has started projecting women in positive way showing their educational concerns and progress, female health issues and role of women in economic development. Media transmit sex-typed behaviors via novels, stories, and cartoon movies. Children learn sex biased roles and values.

Community

Community greatly influences the decision making, achievement of goals or taking responsibilities. In the same way when an individual try to violate norms values or prevailing sex-type behaviors community oppose his/her and force him/her to follow traditional patterns. When women get some higher status than prevailing sex-biased stereotypes, because of her personal effort and individual abilities, she has to face certain obligations from community and keep herself on the way of success. The community's reaction to individual's action influences his/her sex-type behavior.

Work Environment

In choosing an occupation sex-typed behavior is very important. Male and female both think while selecting an occupation that it is according to his/her sex-role or not. Sex-typing also affect the behavior at working environment. When a woman wants to enter in professional life she has to take into consideration her sex-typed behavior and needs of profession. Generally the same nature of work done by male and female worker is given different weightage and males are given privilege for promotion. Theories before feminism were based on physiological differences; believe that female personality characteristics are dependent, low in mechanical abilities and resultantly cause low achievement level of women in professional life. Feminist theories have influenced the sex-typing.

In case when a woman wants to achieve higher professional status relying on her individual abilities she has to sacrifice her sex-role.

Problems for working women in community: Harassment at workplace, Discriminative behavior of male colleagues, Obstacles in the way of progress etc. these are all due to negative sex-biased stereotypes prevailing in the society.

Conclusion

Sex-roles are important for the development of any society, but these roles should give equal opportunities of development for both sexes. Specific sex-roles should not be perceived superior or inferior as it causes rigidity in behavior patterns and affect the process of social development.

LESSON 15

GENDER STEREOTYPES

- Gender stereotypes are beliefs about the typical characteristics and behaviors of men and women
- Stereotyping is universal
- It is cultural phenomenon
- Some stereotypes are culture specific, whereas most are universal.
- A stereotype can be thought of a schema about member of an identifiable group
- Stereotypes are based upon, depict, and strengthen already held prejudices.
- When people hold stereotypes about others, they do not see them as individuals in their own sight, but in the light of pre-formed beliefs.
- When you see a person, a woman for example, about whom you hold a stereotype, your relevant stereotype schema is activated.
- This activation is automatic, like most other schema.
- Walter Lippmann (1992), a journalist, was the first one to use the term "stereotype" in the social sciences' context.
- He described stereotype as "pictures in our head".
- For Lippmann stereotypes are negative in nature that protects the relative social standing and interests of those who hold these.
- "Racism" and "Sexism" are the two main contexts in which stereotypes are mostly held and applied.
- Stereotypes not only affect peoples' interpersonal and inter-group relations and networking; they also affect one's perception of one's own abilities as well as status as members of a society.

Some commonly held Gender Stereotypes

- ☐ Stereotypes are primarily negative in nature i.e. usually negative characteristics are attributed to certain sections of population.
- ☐ Negative stereotypes are attached to the "out group", and positive attributes are associated with "ingroup".
- ☐ Stereotypes are formed and held, as a result of cultural beliefs, practices, and traditions.
- ☐ If the society is male-dominated, then most positive attributes will be attached to males.
- ☐ Such attributes portray men as more capable, able, and strong as compared to women.

Faculty Male stereotypes Female stereotypes

Faculty	Male stereotypes	Female stereotypes
Biology/Physiology	Strong, powerful, never tired, energetic	Weak, frail, dainty, charming
Emotions	Stable, never cry, can hold emotions, aggressive, serious, brave, unemotional	Gentle, soft-hearted, cry soon, can not hold emotion, sensitive, emotional, sentimental, fearful
Intelligence/ Cognition	Intelligent, wise, makes decision, clear thinking, logical	Dreamy, less capable
Attitude	Assertive, courageous, active, adventurous, responsible	Dependent, submissive, superstitious, talkative, curious, irresponsible

Similarities in Stereotypes across-cultures

In a 25 nation study a core set of descriptions was identified.

- ☐ These descriptions were consistently used to describe men and women in these cultures
- ☐ The male descriptions included: active, adventurous, ambitious, determined, disorderly, logical, stern, and wise and a number of others.
- ☐ The female descriptions included: affected, affectionate, charming, dreamy, gentle, mild, talkative, weak and others.

Stereotypes of Warmth and Expressiveness versus Competence

- ☐ Members of western societies hold well-defined gender stereotypes.
- ☐ These prevail regardless of age, economic status, and social and educational background
- ☐ Western societies' stereotypes are skewed in favor of men, than women.
- ☐ The socially preferred traits are attached more to men.
- ☐ These societies prefer competence over warmth and expressiveness
- ☐ Competence related traits are associated with men: independence, objectivity, competence.
- ☐ Warmth and expressiveness traits, attached to females include gentleness and awareness of others' feelings.

How are Gender Stereotypes formed?

The formation of gender stereotypes can be understood and explained in the light of these approaches:

- i) Psychoanalytic Approach
- ii) Behaviorist Approach
- iii) Authoritarian Model Approach
- iv) Observational Learning Approach
- v) Feminist or Patriarchal Approach

Psychoanalytic Approach: Gender stereotypes are formed as a result of a child's identification with the same-sex parent.

Behaviorist Approach: Children learn gender stereotypes as a result of reinforcement from parents and significant others.

They are rewarded for adopting the stereotypes held by parents, and punished for not adopting them, or for adopting beliefs contrary to the one, held by parents.

Authoritarian Model Approach: Authoritarian parents do make expression of their love for children, but at the same time make them behave the way they want them to. Children of such parents learn and adopt stereotypes held by parents almost automatically, since that is the only way they are expected to behave. Punishment or negative reinforcement is employed by parents for making children learn the desired behaviors.

Observational Learning Approach: Children learn gender stereotypes as a result of their observation of parents, peers, and others. They see these people as holding and practicing strongly held beliefs, and being rewarded or respected for it.

Feminist Approach: Gender stereotypes are formed, held, and practiced as a result of male-dominance, and female-subservience in the society.

Men have been oppressing women since they have been in dominant positions.

It suits them, for maintaining their dominance that females are kept in second-rate citizen status. Traditional stereotypes imply that women are weak, less capable and dependent upon their male counterparts.

The Socialization Process and Learning of Gender Stereotypes

- Children learn gender stereotypes as part of the socialization process.
- Socialization is the process whereby culture is transmitted from one generation to the other.
- They are taught, and they learn, the societal beliefs and values.
- A significant component of this process is the learning of gender roles, and stereotypes.
- Children are taught gender-appropriate behaviors for themselves, as well as ways of perceiving members of the opposite gender.

Gender stereotypes and role one learnt are through various means:

i) Direct instructions:

Parents direct children how to behave and how not to e.g., "Don't cry Boys! Don't cry, Are you a girl?"

"Don't try to fix the switch daughter! Let your brother do it! It is boy's job."

ii) Parents intentionally playing the role models:

At times parents act as models of certain behaviors intentionally, deriving the child to watch them and copy them. E.g. the father tells mother that she is not capable and wise enough, in front of the son.

The purpose of this behavior is twofold: the boy learns a socially practiced norm as well as learning to respect the father as the most capable member of the family.

iii) Games Children Play:

Children are taught gender stereotypes by providing the opportunities to play particular types of games involving specific categories of toys.

Girls are given dolls to play with, and discouraged from playing with "boys' toys".

Boys are allowed to play with toys considered to be "boys' toys", and usually strictly discouraged from playing with dolls, or utensils.

Boys are even ridiculed at their interests in "girlish games" or toys.

iv) Involvement in household Chores:

Girls are encouraged to indulge into domestic chores, like cooking, washing, or cleaning.

Boys are usually not involved in such chores.

This results in learning the concept of "girls' work" and "boys' work".

v) The family structure and operation:

The very nature of the way families operate in socialization, itself, teaches stereotypes.

The treatment of the mother by the father, the behavior of the mother and the responsibilities carried out by the father reinforce stereotypes.

vi) Education

School and curricula also transmit stereotypical thinking.

Teachers teach boys not to act like girls, as if behaving like a girl is something deplorable.

Textbooks portray males as capable and professional.

Females are depicted as non-professional, and usually home bound.

Text books mostly show man as doctors, surgeons, pilots, scientists, lawyers or engineers.

Females are shown to be doing less prestigious jobs like house work or nursing.

Fifty percent of the work in fields is done by females in rural areas, but one hardly sees a woman depicted as a farmer.

vii) Media

Media, especially electronic media play an important role in strengthening stereotypes.

Females are mostly portrayed as mere show pieces, articles of attraction less intelligent (in fact stupid), talkative, quarrelsome, and cowardly.

Men are shown as brave, intelligent and saviors of women.
Gender roles play a very significant part in Stereotyping

Gender Stereotypes and Reality

Aggressiveness as a Stereotype

- Research shows that men are more aggressive than women; especially in terms of aggressiveness causing pain or physical injury (Eagly & Steffen, 1986).
- In case of adult phenomenon like spousal abuse, men are typically involved as the aggressors and women as victims (Strauss & Gelles, 1986).
- However there is some evidence suggesting that sex differences in aggression diminish with age

Leadership

- There is a greater likelihood for men, than women, to emerge as leaders in initially leaderless groups.
- This is truer when the groups are short-term, and when they involve tasks not requiring complex social interaction (Eagly & Karan, 1991).
- A review of leadership literature revealed that female leaders as compared to men are:
 - o More likely to adopt a democratic or participative style
 - o Less likely to adopt an autocratic or directive style (Eagly & Johnson, 1990)
- The review also provided some indication that women are more likely use an interpersonally oriented style, and men are more likely to adopt a task-oriented style.

LECTURE 16

DEVELOPMENTAL STAGES OF GENDER STEREOTYPES

The development of gender stereotypes takes place in three stages. Children as young as three years of age tend to learn stereotypes.

Stage 1:

- About 3 years of age.
- Characteristics and behaviors directly associated with males and females have been learnt.
- However indirect associations with gender that are essential requirements for the formation of gender stereotypes are not learnt yet. (which tasks for which gender and specially of their own gender)

Stage 2:

- About 6 years of age. (the things which are not directly seen)
- The development of indirect associations for behavior associated with gender begins to develop.
- However at this stage associations with only children's own gender develop, and not those associated with others'.

Stage 3:

- About 8-10 years of age.
- Indirect associations with not only own, but the other gender have been learnt.
- An 8-10 year old is capable of stereotypical judgments concerning men as well as women. (Martin, hood, and Little, 1990)

Approaches to the Formation of Gender Stereotypes

The formation of gender stereotypes can be understood and explained in the light of the following approaches:

- Psychoanalytic Approach
- Behaviorist Approach
- Authoritarian Model Approach
- Observational Learning Approach
- Feminist or Patriarchal Approach

Psychoanalytic Approach:

Gender stereotypes are formed as a result if a child's identification with the same-sex parent. (conflict with same sex parent)

Behaviorist Approach:

Children learn gender stereotypes as a result of reinforcement from parents and significant others.

They are rewarded for adopting the stereotypes held by parents, and punished for not adopting them, or for adopting beliefs contrary to the ones, held by parents.

Authoritarian Model Approach:

Authoritarian parents do make expression of their love for children, but at the same time make them behave the way they want them to.

Children of such parents learn and adopt stereotypes held by parents almost automatically, since that is the only way they are expected to behave.

Punishment or negative reinforcement is employed by parents for making children learn the desired behaviors.

Observational Learning Approach:

Children learn gender stereotypes as a result of their observation of parents, peers, and others.

They see these people as holding and practicing strongly held beliefs, and being rewarded or respected for it.

Feminist Approach:

Gender stereotypes are formed, held, and practiced as a result of male-dominance, and female subservience in the society.

Men have been oppressing women since they have been in dominant positions.

It suits them, for maintaining their dominance that females are kept in second-rate citizen status.

Traditional stereotypes imply that women are weak, less capable and dependent upon their male counterparts. (Stereotypes are formed in a way to maintain rule of men)

Implications and Consequences of Stereotyping

Gender stereotypes whether positive or negative in nature can have a deep and serious impact.

Stereotypes can influence the way one perceives, interprets, and recalls gender- related information.

The **major implication of stereotypes** is in the form of:

1. Prejudices Is a negative evaluation of a group without judging or evaluating reality.
2. Discrimination
3. Faulty perceptions and interpretations of gender related behavior

Prejudices and stereotyping:

Prejudice is a negative evaluation of a group without judging or evaluating reality.

Stereotypes not only lead to prejudices, but also strengthen the ones already existing.

Prejudices entail feelings of worth for the in- group, and devaluation for the out- group.

Prejudices in turn lead to discrimination, thus leading to more serious personal and social consequences. As a result of stereotypes, and the subsequent prejudices, people tend to hold positive biases towards the in- group and stick to the negative perceptions of the out- group.

For example, if women are thought to be non- serious, foolish, and less capable of wise decision making, then they will not only be perceived like that but will also be kept out of major decision making even when it concerns their own life and welfare.

But gender stereotypes do not always lead to prejudices that directly end up in negative behaviors.

- A meta-analysis has shown that women received slightly more favorable ratings than men.
- People generally have a positive feeling about the stereotypical characteristics of women, believing that these were fine examples of human qualities.
- Then how come women experience discrimination as a result of stereotyping? Focusing upon their conceptualization of sexism, Glick, Fiske, and colleagues have tackled this issue in their research.
- They propose that sexism has two aspects:

Hostile sexism:

Negative in nature; i.e., **having negative attitudes towards women.**

Benevolent sexism:

Having positive attitudes towards women, which in turn actually lead to superior women, and to their subservience?

Therefore the traditional stereotypes imply that women deserve respect, a special treatment, and need to be set on a pedestal. As a consequence of this perception, women are seen as weak, less competent, and more in need of protection than men. Therefore it can be assumed that it is the favorable traits that are associated with women stereotypically, that perpetuate their lower status

For example think of the consequences of a young man offering his bus seat to a young woman about his age, who is perfectly healthy?

In one study, the male participants were asked to engage in a task involving division of labor. They had to decide as to what type of tasks will they do, and what type will be done by their partners.

The participants tended to allocate more “feminine” tasks to their partners when they believed that their partners were females; The case was the opposite when they believed that their partners were males). Sadkar & Sadkar (1994) have reported a study which revealed how teachers’ behavior can be influenced by their expectancies about male and female students.

Gender Stereotypes and Self Perceptions

Gender stereotypes have an impact upon people’s expectancies for themselves. Gender stereotypes form sort of a social pressure to behave in a certain manner. For example if it is generally believed in a family and a society that girls cannot be good in science subjects, then girls start feeling like that and do not feel confident about their possible achievement and success in studying science subjects. People in general have a tendency to confirm the stereotypes held about their gender.

As opposed to racism, or other stereotypes, gender stereotypes are also strengthened by the people about whom these are held. Men tend to try to be more ‘masculine’ and women try to be more “feminine”. In most societies men displaying “manly traits”, and women displaying “womanly traits” are evaluated more positively and viewed as more psychologically healthy than those who do not (Brown, & Geis, 1984). Striving to meet such strictly set standards may cause problems for them.

Stereotypes and self fulfilling prophecies:

“Self-fulfilling prophecy is the process whereby a perceivers beliefs, about a target person can elicit behavior from the target person that will confirm the expectancy” (Deaux, Dane, & Wrightsman, 1993).

Stereotypes entail expectancies, which in turn lead to self fulfilling prophecies.

Therefore stereotypes and prejudices lead to self fulfilling prophecies at one hand, and discrimination on the other.

Faulty perceptions and interpretations of gender related behavior

When people have stereotyped beliefs about others, then they tend to perceive them accordingly, and try to fit even their unclear behaviors into the biased schema.

For example if women are considered to be thoughtless then when a woman takes a just but quick decision, it will be perceived as an thoughtless act without any evaluation of its rightness; and when she is in a hurry about something else, it will be taken as a manifestation of impulsiveness regarding the issue in question.

When girls, in our society, are told that they are weak, and only men can protect them, then they do not develop a courage to go out on their own; somebody has to escort them, and that can be a year old brother. And we can well imagine the pressure of responsibility on the young boy? But this is how boys are taught to feel strong, and girls made dependent.

Research has shown that when males and females perform similarly on a task, people interpret their success differently; males’ success is attributed to their ability, whereas females’ success is more likely to be attributed to their luck (Burgner, & Hewstone, 1993; Eagly, 1987).

Illusory correlation

People, both children and adults, have a tendency to maintain the stereotypes they have formed, as a result of a cognitive process called illusory correlation (Meehan, & Janik, 1990).

It is “the mistaken perception of co-variation between two events when no correlation exists, or the perception of a correlation as stronger than it actually is” (Meehan, & Janik, 1990).

As a result of this process people see relationship between gender and different behaviors when there is no relationship; they also perceive the relationship, if any, as a strong one when it is actually not.

Research has shown that this correlation operates in 2nd and 4th grade children; the way it operates is consistent with developing gender stereotypes.

Distortions in children’s memory for gender related information may be created as a result of children’s tendency to gender stereotype (Meehan, & Janik, 1990; Susskind, 2003).

However other research suggests that counterstereotypical information is not ignored by children (Susskind, 2003).

Sex role Strain:

The traditional standards set for ideal manhood are so stringent, demanding, and hard to achieve that many men find it tough to meet these.

Many men try to escape the expectations and prohibitions associated with their traditional role.

For many men, adherence to the traditional male role identity is a strain.

In the 1960s and 1970s, a new trend emerged whereby men and women started departing from the conventional gender role identities. Many men deviated from the traditional masculine norms

The Sex Role Strain model presented by Pleck (1981, 1995) describes and explains the strain experienced by men.

The strain is also known as Gender Role Strain now.

According to this model, the strain is felt by those males who adhere to the traditional expectations and are successful in doing so.

Lesson 17

CULTURAL INFLUENCE & GENDER ROLES

Although gender stereotypes are almost universal, and gender roles too are similar across the globe, still there is evidence that cultural practices and norms have an influence on how different societies form gender identities.

Therefore one can expect to find gender roles and identities totally different from those traditionally held. Some cultures are exceptional models of how a culture allocates, and cultivates gender roles. This is an evidence of the fact that gender differences are a cultural thing and has no solid biological origin.

Israeli Kibbutzim

- The Kibbutzim are collective settlements in Israel.
- These settlements are an example of a society practicing social and gender equality in all respects.
- There is no distinction of male and female tasks.
- Sex of a Kibbutzim member is almost irrelevant in most situations.
- Both men and women perform all sorts of tasks.
- They have an equal share and say in work as well as decision making.
- Tasks like cooking cleaning, child care and maintenance of buildings are performed by both men and women.
- Child rearing practices are used same for male and female children.
- Advocates of the socio-cultural viewpoint use this case as a support evidence for their case.
- However the supporters of the biological perspective quote the case of women in the Kibbutzim who did not like the idea of staying away from their children for longer durations during the day; this gives a clue to the existence of innate female or motherly instincts (Tiger, and Shepherd, 1975). Margaret Mead's "Sex and Temperament in Three Primitive Societies"
- One of the classic investigations of gender and cultural influences was made by Margaret Mead, which has been reported in her Sex and Temperament in Three Primitive Societies (1935, 1963).
- She studied three primitive societies in New Guinea: Arapesh, Mundugumor, and Tchambuli.
- Her observations reveal how cultures form and shape gender roles; males and females become what their cultures make them.

Arapesh

From the conventional western viewpoint, the Arapesh were "feminine" in their attitudes and behaviors that were extremely similar. Both men and women were gentle, sensitive to others and cooperative.

Mundugumor

The members of the Mundugumor society were cannibals and head hunters. Men and women had similar roles like the Arapesh. However the Mundugumor were, as opposed to the Arapesh, typically selfish and aggressive. If the Arapesh were "feminine" from one traditional perspective, then the Mundugumors were "masculine" in approach, both men and women.

Tchambuli

Gender differentiation was found in Tchambuli. Males and females had clearly defined gender roles. Men in Tchambuli performed the roles traditionally performed by females in other societies. Tchambuli men were submissive, emotional, and nurturing towards children; women on the other hand tended to be dominant, and rational (Macdonis, 1995). These three cases show how any person, man or woman can be taught to be masculine or feminine.

Agents of Socialization and Gender-Roles

Family

Research shows that although parents may not treat male and female children much differently, the nature of their interaction is different. Even in infancy fathers may indulge into more “roughhousing” play with boys than with girls (Mc Bride-Chang, and Jacklin, 1993). Children are encouraged to play with different types of toys (Etaugh, and Liss, 1992). In case of grown up children, they are assigned household chores depending upon their sex (Mc Hale et al., 1990).

School

The educational system, the school Curricula, the textbooks, and the teachers’ attitudes contribute very significantly to gender-role socialization. Teachers reward and encourage sex-appropriate behaviors (Fagot et al., 1985; Ruble, and Martin, 1998). Teachers have a tendency to pay more attention to male students; they help them, praise them and also scold them more often than females (Sadker, and Sadker, 1994). Similarly in textbooks men are usually portrayed as more capable, able, heroic, professional, wiser and adventurous. Females are usually shown as indulging into household chores or doing a second rate job, or assisting men.

Media

Media generally portrays women as attractive well mad-up, good looking, but not much competent, wise, or professional. Men may not be as good looking as females, but are shown to be more competent, self-reliant, courageous, independent, and professional.

Lecture 18

DEVELOPMENT OF GENDER ROLE IDENTIFICATION

The process of the development of gender role identification involves three aspects:

1. Gender Role Preference
2. Gender Role Adoption, and
3. Gender Role identification (Lynn, 1959)

The child prefers attributes and objects associated with his/her sex, adopt these, and identifies one's self as a member of that sex and sees others as different.

Gender Role Preference

It is the perception that the role of one sex is more desirable in comparison to the other. This preference begins at around 3 years of age and is quite firm and established by 5 years of age. This preference is commonly manifested in children's preference for toys considered to be associated with the sex of the ones going to play with them; toys are seen as "boys' toys" and "girls' toys".

Gender Role Adoption

Displaying sex-typed or sex-related behaviors. In this aspect children adopt observable, sex-related behaviors performed by members of their own sex. There are difference in gender role adoption by boys and girls. In case of girls, gender role adoption and gender role identification develops simultaneously with gender role identification. For boys the processes follow a sequence. In case of girls when they start exhibiting sex-typed behavior, at the same time they begin internalization of the female role and its related attributes (Williams, 1987) In a study reported by Ward, 1969, girls, 5 and 7 years of age, could perceive similarities between their mothers and themselves; same aged boys could not do so with reference their fathers.

Gender Role identification

In incorporating the response characteristics of a gender role into one's personality. In early childhood both boys and girls are closely attached to the mother, but development of gender identity requires boys to detach from the existing behavioral pattern. Gender role identification is easier for girls, since all they have to do is to elaborate the early parented identification. The boy has to step out of the early parental identification, learn and adopt the "masculine" role.

Gender Identity, Gender Roles and Socialization

Gender identity refers to children's identification and acceptance of themselves as male or female. It is the "awareness developed in early childhood that one is male or female" (Papalia, Olds, and Feldman, 2001).

Although used interchangeably, the terms "gender identity" and "gender roles" have a different connotation. Gender identity is more of an internal phenomenon, whereas gender roles pertain to observable behaviors typically associated with the two genders. Children may have developed gender identity but may not behave in a gender typical way.

Basic ingredients of gender identity

Certain elements have to be present, in order for a child to develop gender identity:

- a. The awareness that human beings exist in two categories with separate labels i.e. males and females.
- b. Males and females are different from each other in terms of their characteristics.
- c. What behaviors or activities are undertaken by men and women?
- d. The basic cognitive data or information about the basis on which the child fits into one category or the other.

Gender Identity in Early Infancy

Infants do not have a sense of gender identity; however parents usually set up the environment in such a manner that children, as they grow in age, are automatically steered toward developing accurate gender identity. Some research evidence suggests that even infants have some sense of gender typical or atypical behaviors. In one study 7, 9, and 12 month old infants could distinguish between male and female faces when showed their photographs. The distinguishing cue was the length of hair of the person (Fagot, and Leinbach, 1994; Leinbach and Fagot, 1993). Another study yielded some clues to suggest that 24 months old infants have some knowledge of the gender-typical or gender-atypical activities. Infants attended to those photographs for longer durations where people were performing gender-atypical activities (Serbin, Poulin-Dubois, and Eichstedt, 2002). 12 and 24 months old children were studied in another research that investigated their knowledge of gender-typical toys. It was revealed that girls demonstrated some such knowledge but not the boys (Serbin, Poulin-Dubois, Colburne, Sen and Eichstedt, 2001).

Beginning of the use of gender labels

When children start talking, they start using different words denoting gender. This is the beginning of gender-labeling. Children may make errors in their use of gender labels in the beginning e.g. a girl addressing herself as a boy or labeling boys as girls. This error may be found more commonly in languages like Urdu that treat not only people but also all objects and even events as male or female and grammar changes with the gender of the person or object being talked about. But children soon overcome this problem with the guidance of significant others. Gender-labeling has been observed to develop after 18 months of age. In a study by Fagot and Leinbach, (1989), no toddler under 18 months of age could pass the gender-labeling tasks. The gender-labeling task could be done successfully by few children 20 months olds (Levy, 1999). Most children are capable of correct gender-labeling by 24 months of age. Correct gender labeling by half of the 27 months olds sampled has been reported in a study (Fagot and Leinbach, 1989). Another study found that 67% of two-year olds could use gender-labeling accurately. All 28 months olds have been reported to be successful in gender-labeling (Levy, 1999).

Knowledge of Gender-related Behavior, Traits and Attributes

Successful gender-labeling does not ensure that the child can successfully adopt and understand gender roles. Their labeling may not be based upon accurate cues of information; they may label a person as male or female considering his/her dress or haircut. Accurate understanding and knowledge about gender-related behaviors and characteristics develops after accurate gender labeling.

Some indication of the understanding of male and female categories, and objects associated with each category has been found in 20-28 months olds (Levy, 1999).

Research shows that 3 year olds are able to label the sexes, from groupings based on gender, and exhibit some knowledge of the behaviors typically associated with men and women (Martin, and Little, 1990; Ruble, and Martin, 1997). Most children have not developed gender-constancy at three years of age. Although they are aware of their own gender they think gender can be changed by changing appearance e.g. hairstyle, make-up or dress.

Gender Constancy, Stability, Consistency, and gender Discrimination

Gender constancy refers to the knowledge that gender is a permanent an unchangeable feature of one's self. Gender-stability and gender-consistency are two cognitive ingredients of gender constancy. Gender stability refers to the awareness and knowledge the gender is a stable personal characteristic. Gender consistency refers to the beliefs that gender is an unchangeable characteristic, that remains fixed and unalterable even when appearances or actions change.

Gender stability can be observed in children even in the absence of gender-consistency, but the latter can not be in the absence of the former (Martin, and Little, 1990). Most children, by years of age are successful in tests of gender-discrimination and gender-stability; they also have developed an understanding of gender-typical clothes and toys that is closer to the stereotype. But this can not be taken as a rule. Preschoolers and even some elementary school children may not have acquired gender-stability and gender-consistency (Warin, 2000). In elementary school children, changed appearance, and changed name of a character may produce confusion about the character's gender (Beal, and Lockhart, 1989). Once children have developed both gender-stability and gender-consistency, gender becomes more salient aspect of their lives. They are more concerned about gender-appropriate behavior and making gender friends (Warin, 2000). Children who develop gender constancy become motivated to adopt gender role behaviors, causing them to avoid some activities and engage in others. Therefore gender constancy is accompanied by a motivation to adopt, and practice gender-typical behaviors.

External variables contributing to gender identity

- ☐ Parental attitudes
- ☐ Peers and siblings
- ☐ School
- ☐ Media

Lesson 19

GENDER DIFFERENCES IN PERSONALITY

Gender Differences in Personality

Men and women have been found to be different on a number of dimensions of personality. On some characteristics male score higher and on some females. In case of some traits stereotypically thought to be female traits, men score higher e.g. in case of talkativeness. Researches on gender differences do not provide us any conclusive evidence, and a basis to consider men and women as two entirely different entities. Some differences has been found, however research shows that these differences are insignificant and inconsistent According to Feshbach et al., 1996, "There appear to be relatively few basic psychological differences between the sexes, although members of the tow sexes are socialized behave in different ways." Research does not provide substantial evidence of gender differences in most traits, aggression being an exception.

Gender and aggression

There is no shortage of empirical evidence that males are more aggressive than females. This difference in manifested even in early childhood. Even in children 2 years of age, boys display more aggression than girls and this tendency persist throughout the life span. When compared in terms of their reaction to their own aggression, women feel more anxiety and guilt over their aggression. They are more concerned about its effects on their victims. Physical aggression is much more common in boys, than in girls (Berger, 2000). Relational aggression or social aggression is considered more hurtful than physical aggression, in older children, especially girls. Relational aggression aims to cause psychic pain to the victim rather than a physical pain; it involves insult or social rejection. Research shows that girls use relational aggression more that boys do; however both use this form of aggression. Females' involvement in covert or relational aggression is higher than males; they use snubbing, ignoring, and undermining others more than men do.

But most research shows that differences are greater in terms of physical aggression, but very little in case of verbal aggression. Males tend to be more aggressive than females, both verbally and physically, both children and adults. In most societies men account for violent crime in disproportionately large numbers. Psychologists have different viewpoint regarding aggressiveness being higher in males.

The biological explanation:

This difference is innate and biologically based in hormones

Learning and Social factors explanation:

Gender differences in aggression are not biological; learning and socialization are the responsible factors. This approach argues that if aggressiveness is biologically disposed then it should be the same in children and adults; but if the tendency develops in adulthood, or increase with age, then the social factors are responsible for it. Some research, though not conclusive, suggests that aggression tends to increase with the age of the child.

Gender Differences in Bullying

Bullying is a common phenomenon in school going children. Mostly boys are bullied by older boys, or by peers. In case of girls, another dimension of bullying has been reported. One third of all 9-15 years old girls reported, in the US, having experienced sexual teasing or touching; this

caused or problem so serious that they wanted to avoid school (American Association of University Women Foundation, 1993).

Gender Differences in Non-verbal Communication and behaviors

Men and women differ in terms of non-verbal communication and behaviors. When female are talking they add tag at the end of sentence and raise voice at the end of sentence. Females are more sensitive to subtle non-verbal cues than men. **Women may be better at decoding or interpreting others' body language.** Women disclose their self more. But there are no differences in the display of postures or gestures associated with dominance in non-verbal social situations. Women have a tendency of gaze when someone is talking, especially a man. Men typically do not look at women talking. **Women are generally more formal and tense in their posture and demeanor. Men are generally informal and relaxed. Also women are more likely to smile than men. According to Henley, these differences reflect the power position of men, and submission of women.** It also indicates that men have a higher and women a lower status in society. The gestures used by men are the ones used by people with a high and powerful position; the case is the opposite with women.

Touching

Men and women also differ in terms of the use of touching as part of their non-verbal communication. **Men touch, but do not generally like being touched. Women generally give positive response to touching,** but do not usually take initiative in touching

Expressiveness and Sensitivity

Men and women also vary in their expressiveness and sensitivity to what the other person is conveying, doing, or communicating in general. Women have been found to be superior both in accurately sending, and in understanding non-verbal communication.

Women have an ability to identify negative feeling, except anger in man cases. According to this heightened ability may be a function of women's' less powerful position, and they may have to develop sensitivity to the leakage of negative feelings.

Lesson 20

GENDER DIFFERENCES IN PERSONALITY

Gender Difference in Communication Style

Although women are stereotypically thought to be talkative, it is the men who are more talkative and likely to interrupt others (Key, 1975).

Self Disclosure

Females are more likely to indulge in self-disclosure. They are more likely to “self-disclose” and share their inner ideas and feelings. Men and women consistently differ both in degree of disclosure, and what they actually reveal. As compared to men, women generally disclose more, especially about emotions, relationships, and other personal matters. Men, especially highly masculine men, disclose more in one context, they disclose more with women with whom they anticipate future interaction. In disclosing more to women in such a context these men, seem to want to take the lead in exploring possibilities for a future romantic relationship with the women. According to Henley, men disclose only to women with whom they are intimate, or wish to become intimate. Self-disclosure is also influenced by gender-role stereotypes. People, both men and women, if insecure and socially anxious, are likely to disclose themselves in a way that is consistent with gender-role stereotypes; in doing so they may reinforce and perpetuate those stereotypes.

Gender Differences in Communication

Gender differences are found in non-verbal as well as verbal communication styles. The nature of the content of speech used by women is different from that used by men. Women use a more speech pattern. But the way women talk, leads others to evaluate them as less assertive and tentative. Women have tendency to add tags at the end of an opinion instead of a straight opinion statement. They tend to raise the pitch at the end of a sentence. When they add tags at the end of an opinion, women appear to be less certain about the statement they are making. As a result of their use of tentative language, women are viewed as less competent and knowledgeable; this opinion is not made in case of those using an assertive style of speech. Women, although stereotypically considered talkative, talk less than men. Men are more talkative in a variety of settings. As compared to women, men are more likely to interrupt others. According to Davidson and Duberman in a study of communication between pairs of best friends (1982), there are no differences between men and women in terms of talking about topical issues like politics, current events, movies, or work. However they differ in their discussion of relational and personal topics. Women are more likely to make specific talk about:

- ☐ Personal aspects of their life, and
- ☐ their relationship with the friend

Men and women are not different, and are similar, in reciprocity in self-disclosure; if the intimacy of the disclosure is increased by one person, the other person will be likely to respond similarly (Cozby, 1973).

Gender, Affiliation and Friendship

Some gender differences have been found in affiliation and friendship patterns. Robert Hays and Diana Oxley (1986) report that first-year university resident students' social networks were different in some respects; As compared to women, men included more females in their social

network. The exchange of informational and emotional support with friends was higher in females. In terms of interactions with family members, males and females were alike, but within their networks, females interacted more. The friendship pattern also varies with gender. Verbal communication is an important element in female friendships; female friendships depend more on verbal exchange. In case of male friendships, these evolve from shared activities (Hays, 1985). Some studies have revealed that in interpersonal communication, males use less touching than females.

Gender and Altruism

Altruism is “a special form of helping behavior that is voluntary, costly, and motivated by a desire to improve another person’s welfare, rather than by the anticipation of reward”. It is the “helping behavior that is beneficial to others but clearly requires self-sacrifice” (Feldman, 2002). As far as willingness to indulge into altruistic behavior or self-sacrifice, for others’ welfare is concerned, more females than males report this willingness. However, there is no clear cut empirical evidence to suggest if there are any differences in the actual performance of altruistic behavior. Women are more likely to provide help and emotional support in connection with their traditional role as nurturers. However in situations involving dangerous emergencies, men are more likely to intervene. In a study reported by Huston and others (1981), all people in their sample, who intervene to stop criminals, were men. As part of their traditional role, males are expected to behave heroically in dangerous situations. Men and woman both may consider the consequences of their behaviors in risky situations, but their perceptions and patterns may be different. Men may perceive the costs of intervening in risky situations to be lower than women do, since men are physically stronger and more likely to have relevant skills such as self-defense training.

Gender Self Confidence and Self esteem

When asked to perform a task, especially a new one, females hesitate more than men. If woman are given a task particularly the one usually associated with a male role, women tend to be less self-confidence than men; whereas actually they may perform the same way as men did (Beyer, 1990; Lenney, 1977). Although the gender difference in self-esteem may not be huge, men generally score higher than women; a number of factors contribute to this difference. Women’s perception of their sense of interdependence and connection with others largely influences their self-esteem. Men’s self-esteem on the other hand has roots in their assessment of their unique characteristics and abilities, traits that help them distinguish themselves from other people (Feingold, 1994; King et al., 1999).

Some studies have reported gender differences in terms of how people make positive assessments of their abilities, and their potential for future success. Women generally evaluate themselves more harshly than men. In one survey first-year college students were asked to rate themselves as being above or below average. More men than women rated themselves as above average. They felt they were above average in overall academic and mathematical ability, competitiveness, an emotional health.

Lesson 21

COGNITIVE DIFFERENCES

It is stereotypically believed that men and women are intellectually very different. Men are thought to be more intelligent, and capable of wise and quick decision making. Women, it is thought, are overwhelmed by their emotion, rather than logic or intellect. Even when a man and a woman have the same I.Q level, the man is considered to be more reliable for entrusting a job involving responsibility. Empirical research findings, however, do not indicate the existence of any significant gender differences in terms of intelligence and cognitive ability. Some gender differences have been noted in certain cognitive areas, but there seem to be no true differences in the overall performance or ability (Hedges, and Nowell, 1995). In one analysis (Hedges, and Nowell, 1995), the performance of male and female teenagers on tests of mental ability over the past 30 years was investigated. The analysis yielded very minute 'average difference'. But in case of some tests the member of boys performing very high or very poor was disproportionately large. In case of science tests the number of boys scoring in the top 5 percent was seven times more than that of the girls who scored that high. On math tests twice as many boys than girls scored in the top 5 percent. In tests of perceptual speed and reading comprehension, boys were much more likely than girls to score the lower on the test of writing skills. A significantly little change was seen between the findings of 1960, 1992, the years when testing session used in the study were held.

Gender Differences in I.Q

There is no strong evidence suggesting any real gender difference in I.Q scores. There are only very few studies that showed gender differences in I.Q scores, the differences indicated by these researches are pretty small. However these small differences have become even smaller in the recent past (Aiken, 1984; Halpern, 1986; Hyde et. al., 1990; Maccoby and Jacklin, 1974). Females have generally been found to be out performing males in verbal skills, whereas males have been noted to be performing better on tasks involving spatial ability, or mathematical ability. In one of the earlier studies, Maccoby and Jacklin (1974) reported that boys possessed superior quantitative and spatial abilities; however they were out performed by girls in verbal abilities. This evidence strengthens the stereotypically held views about gender differences in cognitive abilities. However the later and more recent research, that casts doubts on the research suggesting cognitive and gender differences. In this regard the meta analysis done by Hyde and associates (1990) has yielded significant findings based upon sophisticated analysis of 100 studies. This analysis covered the testing of a total of 3, 175, 188 participants in all (Gerow, 1997). The meta analysis showed that 'on average' males and females are not much different in terms of their mathematical performance. In elementary, and middle school females were slightly better than males in computational skills. At high school, or college level males did slightly better than females in mathematical problem solving; this was seen particularly in case of the tests of advanced mathematics. When all age groups were considered, the differences were almost insignificant (Hyde, Fennema, and Lamon, 1990). Research shows that the stereotypically perceived gender differences in mathematical performance are pretty insignificant, and in fact moving towards a decline (Stumpf, 1995; Bellas, and Gafni, 1996; Benbow, Lubinski, and Hyde, 1997).

However no matter how small the gender differences in mathematical ability may be, they are generally skewed in favor of males. There are no or very little differences at elementary level, but in case of teenagers the average achievement of boys is higher than that of girls. Some research has shown that more boys than girls are gifted in mathematics. Majority of high schoolers are usually boys, the boys-to-girls ratio being 4-to-1, as yielded by one North American study. There are various explanations for this edge on part of boys. A positive relationship between spatial ability and math achievement is thought to be one of the contributing variables. It has been seen that males' scores in various measures of visual-spatial ability, beginning from grade school years, are higher than those of females (Voyer, Voyer, and Bryden, 1995). Boys at around ten years of age begin to show better

spatial ability than girls. Spatial ability contributes to a good grasp of geometry; therefore a better spatial ability contributes a better understanding of geometry, which in turn leads to a great part of gender difference in math achievement (Johnson, and Mead, 1987). One plausible explanation of this difference is the social learning explanation; math in most societies is not considered to be a girls' thing.

It is taken to be something dry and hard, therefore an apt choice for males. Research also suggests that educational experiences of students can also be a possible cause of gender differences in average math performance and ability. Some studies have shown a correlation between mathematical skills test scores, and the number and type of math classes taken in high school (Kimball, 1989; Welch et al., 1982). As compared to females, males get enrolled in more advanced math courses, which in turn can be one of the major causal factors in gender differences in math.

Gender and Verbal Ability

Similar trends are found in terms of verbal ability, but in favor of the females. Females, in all age groups exhibit better verbal ability and skills than males on average. Female children start speaking a little earlier than boys do; in their school years, girls have better reading scores and high vocabularies (Halpern, 1997). Literature review done by a number of researchers indicates that females have an advantage, over males, in performance over verbal tasks. In terms of acquisition of language girls exhibit an advantage in their rapidity and proficiency in comparison to boys. This trend is maintained all the way through elementary school years (Halpern, 1994, 1997, 2000; Maccoby, and Jacklin, 1974).

GENDER AND MEDIA

Media, mass media is one of the most influential agents of socialization. Media has a direct impact upon an individual's mind on cognition, affect, and behavior. It may change one's thinking, feeling, and actions, in other words one's attitudes. Or it may further strengthen the already existing attitudes.

Media consists of print, as well as electronic media; electronic media consisting of TV, cinema and internet. Today no other source of impacting people's mind can match the impact of electronic media, particularly television. When TV was not introduced, or was not very commonly available, print media used to be the major agent of attitude formation and change. Television influences one, not through the visual sensation alone, but the auditory sensation as well.

The way men and women are portrayed on television, represents the stereotypes held in a society. Similarly the manner in which newspapers report events also reflects the stereotypically held beliefs about men and women. The fiction and the poetry written in a particular society, at given point in history are also an indication of the role and status of people on the basis of their gender. The fine art created by artists at various times in history is an indicator of how the society perceives men and women.

For example the way women were painted in the past centuries is totally different from the way women are portrayed by the electronic media today. In the Victorian Era, for instance, there was no concept of painting thin, under weight, female figures. A round, slightly over weight, female figure was considered to be a healthy figure. Such figures were representative of fertility, motherhood, and affluence. Very thin bodies, of men or of women, were considered symbols of disease or poverty. The trend is different now.

Even children's books are a source of teaching and promoting stereotypical gender roles. Modern books do have female characters that are braver and more resourceful; friendship between boys and girls is shown more often; however male characters still predominate; females more likely to need help and males more likely to help (Beal, 1994; Evans, 1998). Television, since watched in every household, affects the societal attitudes at a mass level. The sound, picture and the instant delivery of messages are the variables that make television leave a deep, imprinting, effect on the viewers' mind, especially the young ones.

Research shows that the amount of television viewing has an effect on sexism scores of adolescent girls. In case of girls, particularly those of middle class families, their sexism scores increased with heavy television viewing (Morgan, 1982). The same study showed that such impact as not found in case of boys. The attitudes of boys, who already held sexist views, and watched TV heavily, did not change by their TV watching experience.

Television delivers messages not only through the soap operas, but also through talk shows, news, documentaries, and most importantly advertisements. Television programs promote and fortify gender-typed beliefs and behaviors. TV watching provides an opportunity for observational learning. If the characters on TV follow a stereotypical pattern of behavior, then the viewers are highly likely to adopt similar attitudes. This is truer in case of children and adolescents who tend to imitate the attractive characters and models.

In this regard a natural experiment was observed in Canada. In a number of Canadian towns, TV transmission was available for the first time. After two years of TV watching, a significant increase was found in the traditional views of children who previously held relatively un-stereotyped views (Kimball, 1986).

Research also shows that if children watch less stereotyped or un-stereotyped roles on TV, their own views are also un-stereotyped. In one study children watched a series of nontraditional episodes. There involved nontraditional events, e.g., the father and son cooking together.

Children watching these episodes had less stereotyped views than those who had not watched these episodes (J. Johnston, and Ettema, 1982).

Print Media and Portrayal of Genders

Before the advent of electronic media, print media remained the major source of attitude formation. Even after the popularity easy availability of television, the written word did not lose its effect. However in the 21st century, the trend has shifted more and more people, especially youngsters spend most of their time with TV, or computers. Still, the print media remains to be one of the first sources of information that a child comes in contact with. Print media includes newspapers, books, and magazines. So called women's magazines make women more and more conscious of their looks. These magazines make women worry about their appearance and to strive to please men (Peirce, 1990). One negative fall out of this concern on part of women is an over concern about their weight.

Highlighted by Buzybee

The models appearing in these magazines are extremely thin; to an extent where it is not possible for most women to match them. In extreme cases over concern about losing excess body weight may lead to eating disorders; bulimia and anorexia nervosa. Similarly children's story books also promote stereotyped gender roles. The hero usually being a male, the one to be rescued by him is usually a female; the wizards are male and witches females. Media is the most forceful agent of socialization that has a direct impact on minds of the viewers, especially those of the young and impressionable.

Portrayal of Gender in Movies

If you watch movies, whether local or from other parts of the globe, have you ever noticed how men and women are portrayed?? ?

Do you think the depiction of gender roles in movies reflects real life situations? To some extent may be yes!

But we know that the events, atmosphere, and gender roles shown on the silver screen are widely exaggerated. What may bother an objective mind with a scientific approach is not the fact that commercial movies exaggerate life and trigger fantasy above. But what is more a matter of concern is the fact that cinema is a highly attractive, glamorous and effective medium, that presents such role models to the impressionable minds who are far from reality. For example females' characters in movies are very different from what women are like in real life.

One hardly finds a female lead, playing the role of a successful, professional, who is self made, and who runs her own life and that of her children just like any able man does.

Whereas in real life we come across many such women. We really see a woman, in movies, who can rescue someone in emergency; who can scare a robber and make him run away; who can kill a snake or even a rat; who flies an aircraft; or who can protect herself against a rape, robbery or any other form of violence.

The heroine is most of the times the damsel in distress, and who is rescued only when the hero arrives. The female characters are meant only, usually, for romance, dispute or marriage. Men are shown to be strong, brave, independent, professional and wise. They never make wrong decisions. Women can not make quick decisions in crisis; are overwhelmed by emotion and fearful and weak. If such role models are presented in the most glamorous manner, then what will happen to young boys and girls. Cinema is a source of observational learning with all ingredients of attitude formation. Therefore girls learn to be dependant weak, indecisive, non assertive and confused. Boys, on the other hand learn to be self-confident, bold, daring, incharge, self-reliant and macho.

Portrayal of Gender on Television

Television being strong medium providing role models plays a vital role in teaching all sorts of behaviors. There is no dearth of evidence suggesting that children learn violence from TV programs; same in the case with learning gender roles. Children take TV to be a reliable, believable and trustworthy medium. TV is their major source of information. Children obtain their information about various occupations from TV and Believe in this information to be accurate (Greenberg, 1982). Most TV programs on the other hand portray men and women to be indulging into

stereotypical occupations (M. Harris, and Vorhees, 1981; Zuckerman and Zuckerman, 1985). This one can see how children learn that surgery is a male profession and nursing a female profession; university professors are mostly men and women mostly school teachers.

TV shows have traditionally depicted men and women in stereotypical manner (Signorielli and Bacue, 1999). There is always a greater likelihood that men will be depicted as assertive, independent, and competent; women will usually be portrayed as submissive, passive and emotional; (in other words men are shown to be in charge of life and women in need of support).

The women on TV have to be good looking and physically attractive. It is not necessary that men on TV will always be handsome; they may or may not be looking. But most of the women are young, attractive and sexy (Davis, 1990). Men solve mysteries, show acts of chivalry; and when women unmask the villains, it is by mere chance or luck or may be by accident. In case of children's programs, including cartoons, the male characters are active, aggressive, violent and brave; female characters are generally attractive, but dependent. Now a days at times you come across a brave female, in command of life, as well, but not very frequently. Female characters are mostly passive, and more likely to make mistakes; they are deferential, passive and ignored.

TV commercials are one another source of promoting male and female images that may not have much to do with reality. TV commercials have to transmit highly effective messages in a very short duration of time; therefore designed in a manner that makes sure they leave a deep imprint on the viewers' minds. TV ads use only most attractive females; the female model is usually shown to be bothered about trivial matters like the whiteness of laundry, or the shine of dishes. The music channels in their videos etc. portray women as sex objects; in turn influencing viewers' attitudes about sexual conduct (Hansen, and Hansen, 1988; Signorielli, 1993). Research in the US shows that an average child, in a year, watches more than 20,000 TV ads (M. Macklin and Kolbe, 1984). In one study 300 TV commercials were analyzed, the researchers reported that the difference between male and female gender roles as depicted in these commercials was far greater than the actual difference found in the society (Mammy and Simpson, 1981).

Research in Pakistan has revealed similar trends (Shahed, 2003). Majority of people sampled in a survey reported that TV was portraying women as mere show pieces, as a cause of dispute and conflict, as talkative and stupid. The subjects both men and women of all age groups felt that the way women were portrayed on TV did not reflect real life scenario. Besides, they reported on what they felt are the characteristics of an ideal woman and how they would like to see women on TV.

The most preferred traits by the subjects, both genders were:

1. Educated
2. Self-confident
3. Intelligent
4. Binding force for the family
5. Morally strong
6. Good looking
7. Also brave/ not panicky in crisis

Where are the 'good looks' now?? One can see that females, as portrayed on TV usually do not possess these traits. The subjects also listed the most undesirable traits in female; the list included:

- Talkative
- Quarrelsome
- Panicky
- Uneducated

The subjects said that they wanted to see the desirable traits in women in media.

Changing Trends

The way media depicts men and women, and their roles is changing now a days.

With significant real-life changes in gender roles, media, especially TV, is also adopting a realistic path. Same is the case with movies. However the change is not as prominent and rapid in our part of the world as it is in the west. Most TV programs still not only promote the traditional stereotypical gender roles, but also reinforce such views. Today we see women as working outside the home, and we also see men doing shopping or caring for children; however, even today, life is portrayed on TV in a manner more stereotypical than life in the real world (Coltrane, and Adams, 1997; Ruble and Martin, 1998).

Many TV ads now show professional women like bank managers or traveling sales representatives, but most ads show women as housewives, mothers or sex objects who defer to men's needs, wishes and preferences. When even a professional woman, who is supposed to be total in charge of her life, is shown buying something, it is the male who helps her make the right choice. If TV programs or commercials show non-stereotyped roles, shattering the traditional ones, it has an effect. If prime time TV programs follow this track, children take its impact. If children watch non-stereotyped characters in major roles, their views of gender roles are more flexible; they accept males and females in nontraditional occupations (Wroblewski and Huston, 1988). It is responsibility and take charge of initiating social change, for which they have the strongest means that can enter into every household and every viewers' mind.